

# A Morse-Theoretic Construction of the Atiyah–Hirzebruch Spectral Sequence

David Seez

July 6, 2026

## Contents

|                                                                  |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Notation &amp; Conventions</b>                                | <b>2</b>  |
| <b>1 Introduction</b>                                            | <b>6</b>  |
| <b>2 Topological Preliminaries</b>                               | <b>7</b>  |
| 2.1 Compactly Generated Weak Hausdorff Spaces . . . . .          | 7         |
| 2.2 Topological Pairs . . . . .                                  | 9         |
| 2.3 Mapping Spaces . . . . .                                     | 11        |
| <b>3 Vector Bundles and Riemannian Geometry</b>                  | <b>12</b> |
| 3.1 Differentiable Structures on Topological Manifolds . . . . . | 12        |
| <b>4 Complex K Theory</b>                                        | <b>25</b> |
| 4.1 Mathematical Goals . . . . .                                 | 25        |
| 4.2 Classification of Vector Bundles . . . . .                   | 25        |
| 4.3 K-Theory as a Cohomology Theory . . . . .                    | 40        |
| 4.4 Homotopy-Theoretic definition of $K$ . . . . .               | 47        |
| 4.5 K-Theory as a Cohomology Theory . . . . .                    | 56        |
| <b>5 Orientations</b>                                            | <b>65</b> |
| 5.1 Mathematical Goals . . . . .                                 | 65        |
| <b>6 Morse Theory</b>                                            | <b>67</b> |
| <b>7 Title</b>                                                   | <b>70</b> |
| 7.1 Mathematical Goals . . . . .                                 | 70        |
| <b>8 Title</b>                                                   | <b>71</b> |
| 8.1 Mathematical Goals . . . . .                                 | 71        |

## Notation & Conventions

This page collects all notational conventions used in this thesis. It is to be **removed before submission**.

### 1. Manifolds, Maps, and the Differential

| Symbol                        | Meaning & Convention                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $M, N$                        | smooth manifolds (always assumed without boundary unless stated)                                                                                                                                                                    |
| $T_p M, T_p^* M$              | tangent / cotangent space at $p \in M$                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| $TM, T^* M$                   | tangent / cotangent bundle                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| $df$                          | exterior differential of $f: M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ ; a 1-form on $M$                                                                                                                                                            |
| $d_p f = (df)_p$              | differential of $f$ at the point $p$ ; a linear map $T_p M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ .<br><b>Rule:</b> write $d_p f$ (macro <code>\dat{p}f</code> ) when evaluating at a specific point. Write $df$ for the full 1-form / bundle map. |
| $d_p F$                       | for $F: M \rightarrow N$ : the linear map $T_p M \rightarrow T_{F(p)} N$ . Also written $(dF)_p$ ; never write $\frac{d}{dx} F$ for a map between manifolds.                                                                        |
| $\frac{d}{dt}$                | total derivative w.r.t. a <i>single</i> real variable $t$ (roman d, macro <code>\diff</code> ). Use for curves, flows evaluated on a trajectory.                                                                                    |
| $\frac{\partial}{\partial t}$ | partial derivative; use only when <i>at least two independent</i> variables/parameters are present. <b>Never</b> write $\partial/\partial t$ for the time-derivative along a flow line.                                             |
| $\nabla_v f$                  | covariant derivative of $f$ in direction $v$ (Levi-Civita or chosen connection)                                                                                                                                                     |
| $\text{grad}_g f$             | gradient of $f$ with respect to Riemannian metric $g$ ; characterised by $g(\text{grad}_g f, -) = df$                                                                                                                               |

### 2. Flows and Dynamical Systems

| Symbol                      | Meaning & Convention                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\varphi_t(x)$              | flow of a vector field at time $t$ through initial point $x$ . <b>Convention:</b> always write $\varphi_t$ , not $\varphi(t, \cdot)$ ; think of $\varphi_t \in \text{Diff}(M)$ as a one-parameter family of diffeomorphisms. |
| $\varphi_t = e^{tX}$        | flow of the vector field $X$ ; $\varphi_0 = \text{id}$ .                                                                                                                                                                     |
| $\frac{d}{dt} \varphi_t(x)$ | time-derivative of the flow line $t \mapsto \varphi_t(x)$ ; equals $X(\varphi_t(x))$ . Use roman d, never $\partial$ .                                                                                                       |
| $W^u(p), W^s(p)$            | unstable / stable manifold of a critical (rest) point $p$ (macros <code>\Wu{p}</code> , <code>\Ws{p}</code> )                                                                                                                |

| Symbol              | Meaning & Convention                                                                              |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\mathcal{M}(p, q)$ | moduli space of (unparametrised) flow lines from $p$ to $q$<br>(macro <code>\Mflow{p}{q}</code> ) |

### 3. Restrictions and Evaluations

**Core rule:** distinguish carefully between a *fiber*, a *restriction to a subspace*, and a *value/evaluation*.

| Symbol                 | Meaning & Convention                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $E_p$                  | <b>fiber</b> of a vector bundle $E \rightarrow X$ over $p \in X$ . <b>Preferred over</b> $E _{\{p\}}$ for fibers; use macro <code>E_p</code> .                                                    |
| $E _A$                 | <b>restriction</b> of the bundle $E$ to the subspace $A \subseteq X$ ; this is itself a bundle over $A$ . Macro: <code>\restr{E}{A}</code> .                                                      |
| $\xi _A$               | section $\xi \in \Gamma(E)$ restricted to $A$ ; yields $\xi _A \in \Gamma(E _A)$ .                                                                                                                |
| $\xi(p)$ or $\xi_p$    | <b>value</b> of the section $\xi$ at the point $p$ ; an element of $E_p$ . <b>Avoid</b> $\xi _p$ for this; use $\xi(p)$ .                                                                         |
| $\omega_p = \omega _p$ | value of a differential $k$ -form $\omega$ at $p$ ; an element of $\Lambda^k T_p^* M$ . Acceptable to write $\omega _p$ only when the point-evaluation is being <i>emphasised</i> over the fiber. |
| <b>Summary</b>         | $E_p$ = fiber (bundle); $E _A$ = restricted bundle; $\xi(p)$ = value of section; $\omega_p$ = value of form.                                                                                      |

### 5. Chain Complexes and Homology Theories

Three homology theories appear simultaneously; they are always decorated.

| Theory   | Chain complex                        | Boundary / Homology                                                                                                              |
|----------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Singular | $({}^S C_*(X), {}^S \partial)$       | boundary ${}^S \partial$ ; homology $H^S H_*(X)$ .<br>Macros: <code>\ChS</code> , <code>\bS</code> , <code>\HS</code> .          |
| CW       | $({}^{CW} C_*(X), {}^{CW} \partial)$ | boundary ${}^{CW} \partial$ ; homology $H^{CW} H_*(X)$ .<br>Macros: <code>\ChCW</code> , <code>\bCW</code> , <code>\HCW</code> . |
| Morse    | $({}^M C_*(f), {}^M \partial)$       | boundary ${}^M \partial$ ; homology ${}^M H_*(f)$ .<br>Macros: <code>\ChM</code> , <code>\bM</code> , <code>\HM</code> .         |

**Connecting homomorphisms in long exact sequences:**  $: {}^M \delta, {}^{CW} \delta, {}^S \delta$  with the macros: `\connM`, `\connCW`, `\connS`.

**Co-homology:** For co-homology we use upper indices on the co-boundary maps:  ${}^M d, {}^{CW} d, {}^S d$  with the macros: `\cbM`, `\cbCW`, `\cbS`. And for the co-homology we use the homologie macros with upper indices.

| Theory                                                                                                                 | Chain complex | Boundary / Homology |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------|
| <b>Filtration:</b> $F^{p\mathcal{S}}C_*(X)$ for the filtration of the singular complex; boundary is still $\partial$ . |               |                     |

## 6. Vector Bundles and K-Theory

| Symbol                    | Meaning                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\text{Vect}(X)$          | set of isomorphism classes of complex vector bundles over $X$<br>(macro <code>\Kvect{X}</code> ) |
| $[E]$                     | stable isomorphism class / element in $K(X)$                                                     |
| $K(X) = KU(X)$            | complex K-theory (default); macro <code>\K</code> , <code>\KU</code>                             |
| $KO(X)$                   | real K-theory; macro <code>\KO</code>                                                            |
| $\tilde{K}(X)$            | reduced complex K-theory                                                                         |
| $E \oplus F, E \otimes F$ | Whitney sum / tensor product of bundles                                                          |
| $E _A$                    | restriction of bundle $E \rightarrow X$ to subspace $A$ (same convention as §3)                  |
| $E_p$                     | fiber of $E$ over $p$ (same convention as §3)                                                    |

## 7. Spectral Sequences

| Symbol           | Meaning                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $E_{p,q}^r$      | $(p, q)$ -entry on the $r$ -th page of a spectral sequence; macro <code>\Epq{r}{p,q}</code>                                             |
| $d^r$            | differential on the $r$ -th page; $d^r: E_{p,q}^r \rightarrow E_{p-r, q+r-1}^r$ (cohomological convention); macro <code>\drpq{r}</code> |
| AHSS             | Atiyah–Hirzebruch spectral sequence: $E_{p,q}^2 \cong H^p(X; K^q(\text{pt})) \Rightarrow K^{p+q}(X)$                                    |
| $E_{p,q}^\infty$ | abutment / $E_\infty$ -page                                                                                                             |

## 8. Frequently Used Macros (Quick Reference)

| Macro                     | Output   | Use                            |
|---------------------------|----------|--------------------------------|
| <code>\diff</code>        | $d$      | exterior deriv. / total deriv. |
| <code>\dat{p}</code>      | $d_p$    | deriv. at point $p$            |
| <code>\restr{E}{A}</code> | $E _A$   | restriction                    |
| <code>\Wu{p}</code>       | $W^u(p)$ | unstable manifold              |

| Macro                     | Output                | Use                            |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------|
| <code>\Ws{p}</code>       | $W^s(p)$              | stable manifold                |
| <code>\Mflow{p}{q}</code> | $\mathcal{M}(p, q)$   | moduli of flow lines           |
| <code>\ChM</code>         | $\mathcal{M}C_*$      | Morse chain complex            |
| <code>\bM</code>          | $\mathcal{M}\partial$ | Morse boundary                 |
| <code>\HM</code>          | $\mathcal{M}H_*$      | Morse homology                 |
| <code>\ChCW</code>        | ${}^{CW}C_*$          | CW chain complex               |
| <code>\bCW</code>         | ${}^{CW}\partial$     | CW boundary                    |
| <code>\HCW</code>         | $H^{CW}H_*$           | CW homology                    |
| <code>\conn</code>        | $\delta$              | connecting homom. ( $\delta$ ) |
| <code>\K</code>           | $K$                   | K-theory                       |
| <code>\KO</code>          | $KO$                  | real K-theory                  |
| <code>\KU</code>          | $KU$                  | complex K-theory               |
| <code>\Epq{r}{p,q}</code> | $E_{p,q}^r$           | SS entry                       |
| <code>\drpq{r}</code>     | $d^r$                 | SS differential                |
| <code>\Crit</code>        | $\text{Crit}$         | critical point set             |
| <code>\ind</code>         | $\text{ind}$          | Morse index                    |
| <code>\grad</code>        | $\text{grad}$         | gradient                       |
| <code>\euler</code>       | $e$                   | Euler number (roman e)         |
| <code>\ii</code>          | $i$                   | imaginary unit (roman i)       |

## 1 Introduction

## 2 Topological Preliminaries

This section aims to set the playing ground of the thesis. Since Morse theory needs the topological spaces to be rather restricted and the goal is to relate Morse Homology to topological K-Theory, there is an urge to just not worry about topological nuances. However, for proving things we still need the vocabulary of topological notions. This chapter serves to provide the notions and theorems with references whilst omitting the technical proofs. Steenrod himself writes in his article "A convenient category of topological spaces" [Ste67]:

"Our need is to be able to make a variety of constructions and to know that the results have good properties without the tedious spelling out at each step of lengthy hypotheses such as countably paracompact normal, completely regular, first axiom of countability, metrizable, and so forth. It may be good research technique and an enjoyable exercise to analyse the precise circumstances for which an argument works; but if a developing theory is to be handy for research workers and attractive to students, then simplicity of the fundamentals must be the goal."

Whilst Steenrod argues for the category of *compactly generated Hausdorff spaces* the standard nowadays is the category of *compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces*. The latter has direct limits, whilst Steenrod's doesn't. One might wonder why we don't just use the category of CW-complexes, like Hatcher does. There are two reasons for this. The main goal is a Morse theoretic Spectral sequence, which relies on a Morse theoretic filtration. It would be a theoretical drawback to assume that all spaces already omit a CW filtration, as such a filtration naturally already leads to a Atiyah Hirzebruch Spectral sequence. The second reason is, that whilst a lot of pointset topological technicalities can be omitted using CW-complexes, not all of them vanish. This results in the necessity of a discussion of those technicalities, or ignoring the details. Hence we stay away from CW complexes. Let us start constructing this convenient category. All topological constructions that are taught in the compulsory section of a university are assumed to be known. Most proofs are omitted but can be found in [Str].

### 2.1 Compactly Generated Weak Hausdorff Spaces

**Remark 2.1.1** (Notation and Convention). The literature on topological spaces in geometric contexts is widely non-uniform. For this work, a topological space is *compact* if it is quasi-compact (every open cover has a finite subcover) and Hausdorff (every pair of points can be separated by disjoint open subsets).

**Definition 2.1.2** (Compactly Generated). A topological space  $X$  is **compactly generated**, if a subset  $A \subseteq X$  is closed, if and only if for all compact  $K$  and continuous  $f : K \rightarrow X$   $f^{-1}(A)$  is closed.

$\text{def:topPre-compactlyGenerated}$

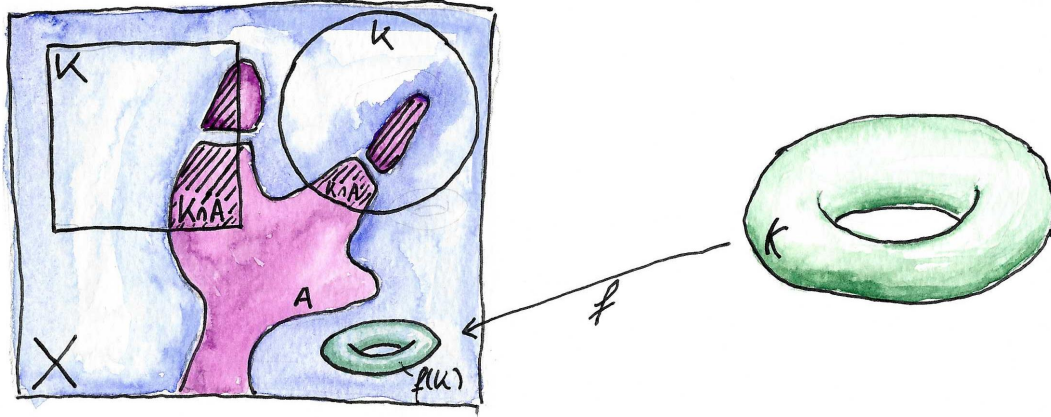


Figure 1: The definition of compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces.

def:topPre-weakHausdorff

**Definition 2.1.3** (Weak Hausdorff). A topological space  $X$  is called weak Hausdorff, if for all compact spaces  $K$  and continuous map  $f : K \rightarrow X$  the image  $f(K)$  is closed in  $X$ .

**Definition 2.1.4.** We call the category of compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces together with continuous functions as morphisms **CGWH**.

prop:topPre-spacesThatAreCGWH

**Proposition 2.1.5.** 1. Every closed subset of a compactly generated weak Hausdorff space is compactly generated weak Hausdorff in the subspace topology.

2. Every locally compact Hausdorff space, and hence every compact space, is compactly generated weak Hausdorff.
3. Every manifold is compactly generated weak Hausdorff.
4. Every metric space is compactly generated weak Hausdorff.
5. Every disjoint union of compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces is compactly generated weak Hausdorff.
6. If  $X$  is compactly generated weak Hausdorff and  $Y$  locally compact Hausdorff, then  $X \times Y$  is compactly generated weak Hausdorff in the product topology.
7. If  $X$  is compactly generated weak Hausdorff and  $Y \subseteq X$  a closed subset of  $X$ . Then the quotient topology on  $X/Y$  is compactly generated and weak Hausdorff.

There is another caveat and reason for the usage of **CGWH**. If we view two CW-complexes as topological spaces, their product might not be a CW-complex. However as objects in **CGWH** their product is a CW-complex. The reason behind this is that the general product doesn't produce the final topology; when it fails to be compactly generated it is strictly coarser than the CW-topology. Passing to the product in **CGWH**



(hence making the topology finer to become compactly generated) repairs this, and the product of CW-complexes is again a CW-complex.

**Remark 2.1.6.** From now on all topological spaces will be compactly generated weak Hausdorff. For such spaces the product  $X \times Y$  always means the product in **CGWH**. Proposition 2.1.5 (6) tells us: If one of the factors is also locally compact Hausdorff, the product in **CGWH** agrees with the classical product.

For the construction of topological K-Theory we will heavily rely on the two theorems from pointset topology:

**Theorem 2.1.7** (Tietze Extension Theorem). *Let  $X$  be a normal space (and hence the theorem is true in **CGWH**),  $Y \subseteq X$  a closed subspace,  $V$  a finite dimensional real vector space, and  $f : Y \rightarrow V$  a continuous map. Then there exists a continuous map  $g : X \rightarrow V$  such that  $g|_Y = f$ .*

**Theorem 2.1.8** (Existence of Partitions of Unity). *Let  $X$  be a compact space,  $\{U_i\}$  a finite open covering. Then there exist continuous maps  $f_i : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  such that:*

1.  $f_i(x) \geq 0$  for all  $x \in X$ .
2.  $\text{supp}(f_i) \subseteq U_i$ .
3.  $\sum_i f_i(x) = 1$  for all  $x \in X$ .

*Such a collection  $\{f_i\}$  is called a **partition of unity**.*

## 2.2 Topological Pairs

**Definition 2.2.1** (Homotopy Extension Property). Let  $(X, A)$  be a topological pair, i.e.  $A \subseteq X$ . The pair satisfies the homotopy extension property if for any map  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  and any homotopy  $f_t : A \rightarrow Y$  with  $f_0 = f|_A$  there exists an extension  $\tilde{f}_t : X \rightarrow Y$  with  $\tilde{f}_t|_A = f_t$  and  $\tilde{f}_0 = f$ . The inclusion  $i : A \rightarrow X$  of such a pair is called a **cofibration**. We denote the category of pairs of compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces where the inclusion is a cofibration by **CGWH**<sub>cof</sub><sup>2</sup>.

A more intuitive but (for  $A$  closed in  $X$ ) equivalent definition is:

**Definition 2.2.2.** If  $(X, A)$  is a topological pair,  $A$  is closed in  $X$  and there is an neighbourhood  $U \supseteq A$  such that  $U$  deformation retracts onto  $A$ . Such a pair is called an **NDR**-pair which stands for neighbourhood deformation retract-pair.

**Remark 2.2.3.** If we encounter an NDR pair in this thesis that lives in a manifold, we will often omit proving the property. A proof would mostly consist of applying the tubular neighbourhood theorem and the collar neighbourhood theorem.

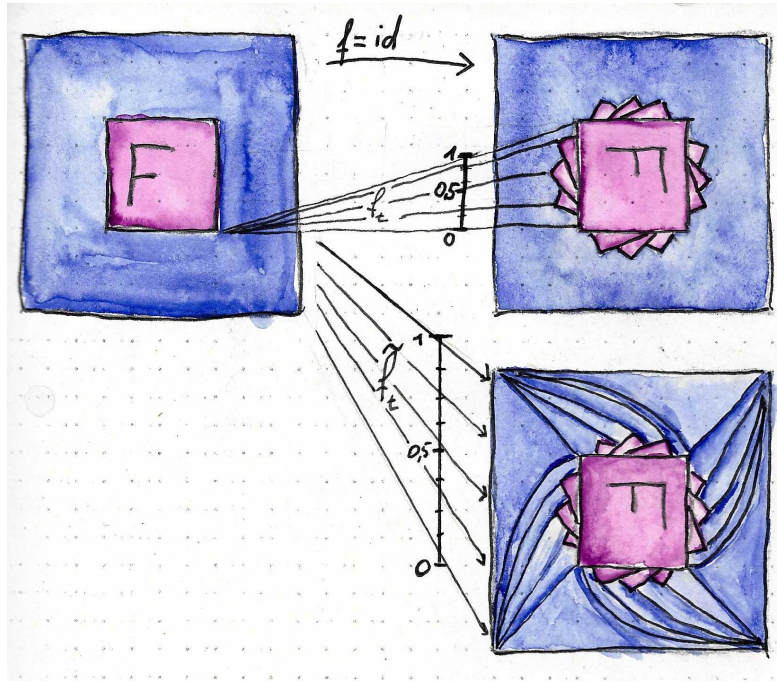


Figure 2: The homotopy extension property for the pair  $(X, F)$ , where  $F$  gets rotated.

lem:topPre-he  
pImpliescontr  
actingisHomot  
opicallyInvaria  
nt

**Lemma 2.2.4.** *If the pair  $(X, A)$  satisfies the homotopy extension property and  $A$  is contractible, then the quotient map*

$$q : X \rightarrow X/A$$

*is a homotopy equivalence.*

*Proof.* Let  $f_t : X \rightarrow X$  be a homotopy extending the contraction of  $A$  with  $f_0 = \text{id}$ . Then the composition  $q \circ f_t$  maps  $A$  to a point and hence factors over  $X/A$  for all  $t$  giving us the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f_t} & X \\ \downarrow q & & \downarrow q \\ X/A & \xrightarrow{\overline{f}_t} & X/A \end{array}$$

Here,  $\overline{f}_t$  denotes the induced map on the quotient. Now  $f_1(A) = pt$  where  $pt$  is a point in  $A$ . So  $f_1$  factors over  $X/A$  and denote the induced map by  $g : X/A \rightarrow X$ . Now  $g \circ q = f_1$  and hence

$$q \circ g(\overline{x}) = q \circ g \circ q(x) = q \circ f_1(x) = \overline{f}_1(\overline{x}).$$

In other words we have the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
X & \xrightarrow{f_1} & X \\
\downarrow q & \nearrow g & \downarrow q \\
X/A & \xrightarrow{\overline{f_1}} & X/A
\end{array}$$

This concludes the proof, since  $g \circ q = f_1 \simeq f_0 = \text{id}$  and  $q \circ g = \overline{f_1} \simeq \overline{f_0} = \text{id}$ .  $\square$

**Definition 2.2.5.** We call a pointed topological space  $(X, x_0)$  well pointed, if the inclusion  $x_0 \rightarrow X$  is a cofibration. We denote the category of well pointed compactly generated weak Hausdorff spaces by  $\mathbf{CGWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$ .

## 2.3 Mapping Spaces

**Definition 2.3.1** (Compact-open topology). Let  $X, Y$  be topological spaces. Then the set of continuous maps  $C(X, Y)$  can be equipped with the topology that has

$$\{V(K, U) \mid K \subseteq X \text{ compact}, U \subseteq Y \text{ open}\} \text{ where } V(K, U) := \{f \in C(X, Y) \mid f(K) \subseteq U\}$$

as a subbasis. For real vector spaces  $V, W$  in the standard topology, this coincides with the topology of  $\text{Hom}(V, W)$  as a subset of  $\mathbb{R}^n$  after identification with the corresponding matrix.

**Proposition 2.3.2.** If  $X$  is compactly generated and  $Y$  compactly generated weak Hausdorff, then  $C(X, Y)$  is compactly generated weak Hausdorff.

**Proposition 2.3.3.** Let  $X, Y, Z$  be objects in  $\mathbf{CGWH}$ . The natural map

$$C(X, C(Y, Z)) \rightarrow C(X \times Y, Z)$$

is a homeomorphism.

prop:kTheo-cu  
rryingIsConti  
nuous

### 3 Vector Bundles and Riemannian Geometry

sec:background-  
d-geometry

Due to differential geometry and the theory of vector bundles being areas of mathematics used by pure mathematicians interested in analytical aspects like curvature, by topologists interested in invariants like Euler characteristics, physicists using the spaces as playgrounds for general relativity theories, and many others, there are numerous competing notational conventions. This thesis lies at the tripoint of differential geometry, dynamical systems, and algebraic topology. Hence, there is no a priori preferred notational convention. In this chapter, we establish the necessary background in the theory of vector bundles and Riemannian manifolds whilst not proving all the basics; we establish the notation used throughout this thesis. We establish manifolds and vector bundles in parallel, as they are interdependent on one another.

#### 3.1 Differentiable Structures on Topological Manifolds

We begin by defining a topological manifold. Afterwards, we equip that space with with increasingly more structure and hence reduce the generality until we arrive at the playground of the thesis:

def:vb-topolo-  
gicalManifold

**Definition 3.1.1** (Topological Manifold). A second countable Hausdorff space  $M$  is called a **topological manifold** of dimension  $m \in \mathbb{N}$ , if it is locally homeomorphic to  $\mathbb{R}^m$ . To be precise, for all  $p \in M$  there exists an open neighbourhood  $U \subseteq M$  of  $p$ , an open set  $V \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m$  and a map  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  that is a homeomorphism. We call the map  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  a **chart around  $p$  on  $M$** , and  $\varphi^{-1}$  a **local coordinate system around  $p$  on  $M$** .

def:vb-differ-  
entiableManif-  
old

**Definition 3.1.2** (Differentiable Manifold). Let  $M$  be a topological manifold of dimension  $m$ .

1. A **differentiable atlas of class  $r \in \mathbb{N} \cup \{\infty\}$**  is a family of charts  $\mathfrak{A} = (\varphi_i : U_i \rightarrow V_i)_{i \in I}$  such that
  - a)  $\bigcup_{i \in I} U_i = M$ , meaning that  $(U_i)$  is an open covering of  $M$ .
  - b) For every pair  $(i, j) \in I^2$ , the **transition function**:

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi_{ij} : \varphi_j(U_i \cap U_j) &\rightarrow \varphi_i(U_i \cap U_j) \\ x &\mapsto (\varphi_i \circ \varphi_j^{-1})(x) \end{aligned}$$

is differentiable of class  $r$ .

We call such an atlas a  $C^r$ -atlas.

2. Two  $C^r$ -atlases  $\mathfrak{A}$  and  $\mathfrak{B}$  are called **equivalent** if the family  $\mathfrak{A} + \mathfrak{B} = (\varphi_i, \varphi_j)_{ij}$  is a  $C^r$ -atlas.

A **differentiable structure of class  $r$**  on  $M$  is an equivalence class  $c$  of  $C^r$ -atlases. For  $r = \infty$ , we call the pair  $(M, c)$  a smooth manifold.

**Corollary 3.1.3.** Every transition function  $\varphi_{ij}$ ,  $i, j \in I^2$  of a differentiable atlas  $\mathfrak{A} = (\varphi_i)_{i \in I}$  is not merely a homeomorphism but also a diffeomorphism. This follows from the fact that  $\varphi_{ij}^{-1} = \varphi_{ji}$  which provides smooth inverses.

def:vb-smooth  
Functions

**Definition 3.1.4** (Smooth Functions). Let  $(M, c)$  be a differentiable manifold of class  $r$  and  $U \subseteq M$  open. We call a continuous function

$$f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

**differentiable of class  $r$** , if for any chart (and hence for all)  $(\varphi_i)_{i \in I} = \mathfrak{A} \in c$  the compositions  $f \circ \varphi_i^{-1}$  are differentiable of class  $r$ . For  $r = \infty$  we define:

$$\mathcal{E}(U) = \{f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \text{ continuous} \mid f \text{ is differentiable of class } \infty\}.$$

**Corollary 3.1.5.** Let  $(M, c)$  be a smooth manifold of dimension  $m$  and  $U \subseteq M$  be an open subset. With pointwise defined operations, the set  $(\mathcal{E}(U), +, \cdot, \circ)$  becomes an  $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra. Furthermore,  $\mathcal{E}$  becomes a sheaf of  $\mathbb{R}$ -algebras.

*Proof.* There is not really a need for a proof. However, it might help to work through the definition of a sheaf. First,  $\mathcal{E}$  is a presheaf, where the restriction in the domain of a function gives the needed restriction homomorphism:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{res}_V^U : \mathcal{E}(U) &\rightarrow \mathcal{E}(V) \\ f &\mapsto f|_V. \end{aligned}$$

The required properties of a presheaf are trivial. Furthermore, this gives a sheaf as the requirement of locality is trivial for functions and the property of gluing is also trivial for functions, since differentiability is a local property.  $\square$

**Definition 3.1.6.** If  $p \in M$  is fix,  $f \in \mathcal{E}(U)$  and  $g \in \mathcal{E}(U')$  such that  $p \in U \cap U'$  we say that  $f$  and  $g$  have the same **germ in  $p$** , if there is another open neighborhood  $W \subseteq U \cap U'$  of  $p$  such that  $f|_W = g|_W$ . This defines an equivalence relation  $\sim_p$ . An equivalence class  $s$  of local functions around  $p$  is called a **germ in  $p$** . We write  $s = f_p$ , if  $s = [f]$  with  $f \in \mathcal{E}(U)$ . We write

$$\mathcal{E}_p(M) = \left( \sum_{U \text{ open}, p \in U} \mathcal{E}(U) \right) / \sim_p$$

for the set of germs, and call it the **stalk in  $p$** . Where  $\sum$  denotes the co-product (disjoint union) in **CGWH**.

**Corollary 3.1.7.** For a smooth manifold  $(M, c)$  the set  $\mathcal{E}_p(M)$  inherits an  $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra structure from the  $\mathcal{E}(U)$ . Furthermore, it carries a natural (evaluation-)homomorphism:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{eval}_p : \mathcal{E}_p(M) &\rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ f_p &\mapsto f(p) =: f_p(p) \end{aligned}$$

The stalks are also local rings with maximal ideal  $\mathfrak{m}_p = \ker(\text{eval}_p)$ . Hence, the pair  $(M, \mathcal{E})$  gives us a locally ringed space.

*Proof.* We only need to verify the local ring structure of the stalks. An element  $f_p \in \mathcal{E}_p(M)$  is invertible if and only if  $f(p) \neq 0$ , equivalently if  $f_p \notin \ker(\text{eval}_p)$ . Thus  $\mathcal{E}_p(M)/\ker(\text{eval}_p)$  is a field, which proves that  $\ker(\text{eval}_p)$  is maximal.  $\square$

**Definition 3.1.8.** Let  $(M, c)$  be a smooth manifold of dimension  $m$  and  $p \in M$ . We call an  $\mathbb{R}$ -linear map  $\delta : \mathcal{E}_p(M) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  a **derivation**, if it satisfies the Leibniz rule:

$$\delta(f_p \cdot g_p) = \delta(f_p)g_p(p) + f_p(p)\delta(g_p) \quad \text{for all } f_p, g_p \in \mathcal{E}_p(M).$$

We call  $\text{Der}_{\mathbb{R}}(\mathcal{E}_p(M), \mathbb{R})$  the set of derivations and give it an  $\mathbb{R}$ -vector space structure by pointwise operations. We define the **tangent space of  $M$  at  $p$**  to be the vector space

$$T_p M := \text{Der}_{\mathbb{R}}(\mathcal{E}_p(M), \mathbb{R}).$$

**Corollary 3.1.9.** Let  $(M, c)$  be a smooth manifold of dimension  $m$  and  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart around  $p$  with  $x_0 = \varphi(p)$  (where  $\varphi \in \mathfrak{A} \in c$ ). Then we define the derivation

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_i(p) : \mathcal{E}_p(M) &\rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ f_p &\mapsto \partial_i(p)(f_p) := \frac{\partial(f \circ \varphi^{-1})}{\partial x_i} \Big|_{x_0}. \end{aligned}$$

This is well-defined and hence gives a tangent vector. Moreover, the family

$$(\partial_1(p), \dots, \partial_m(p))$$

defines a basis of  $T_p M$ . Hence, the dimension of  $T_p M$  is  $m$ .

This is a good point to take a break from smooth manifolds and introduce the structure of vector bundles.

Analogously to the definition of a smooth manifold, we start by defining families of vector spaces and equip them with increasingly more structure:

def:vb-vector  
Bundles

**Definition 3.1.10 (Vector Bundles).** A **complex vector bundle** of rank  $m$  is a surjection

$$\pi : E \rightarrow X$$

such that  $E$  and  $X$  are topological spaces and  $\pi$  is continuous. Furthermore  $\pi$  satisfies:

1. For all  $x \in X$ ,  $\pi^{-1}(x)$  carries the structure of an  $m$ -dimensional  $\mathbb{C}$ -vector space.
2. For all  $x \in X$ , there exist a neighbourhood  $U \subseteq X$  and a homeomorphism

$$\psi : E|_U := \pi^{-1}(U) \rightarrow U \times \mathbb{C}^m,$$

that is compatible in the following sense: Let  $\pi_1$  denote the projection  $U \times \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow U$  onto the first factor. Then

$$\pi_1 \circ \psi = \pi$$

and

$$\psi_x : E_x := \pi^{-1}(x) \rightarrow \{x\} \times \mathbb{C}^m$$

is a vector space isomorphism.

We call  $E$  the **total space**,  $X$  the **base space**,  $E_x$  the **fibre over  $x$**  and  $\psi$  a **local trivialization**.

**Definition 3.1.11.** Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow X$  be a vector bundle. A continuous function  $s : X \rightarrow E$  such that  $\pi \circ s = \text{id}_X$  is called a (global) **section** (if  $s : U \subseteq X \rightarrow E$  we call it a local section). We denote the space of global sections by  $\Gamma(E)$  and by  $\Gamma(U)$  the space of local sections over an open subset  $U \subseteq X$ .

def:vb-homomorphismOfVectorBundles

**Definition 3.1.12** (Homomorphism of Vector Bundles). A **homomorphism between two vector bundles**  $\pi : E \rightarrow X$  and  $\tilde{\pi} : F \rightarrow X$  over the same base space is a continuous function  $\varphi : E \rightarrow F$  such that:

$$1. \quad \begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & F \\ \downarrow \pi & \swarrow \tilde{\pi} & \\ X & & \end{array} \quad \text{commutes.}$$

2. For all  $x \in X$  the function  $\varphi_x : E_x \rightarrow F_x$  is linear.

def:vb-pullbackOfVectorBundles

**Definition 3.1.13** (Pullback of Vector Bundles). Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow Y$  be a vector bundle,  $X$  be a topological space and  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  be continuous. Then we define the **pullback**  $f^*\pi : f^*(E) \rightarrow X$  as follows: The total space  $f^*(E)$  is defined as the subspace of  $(x, e) \in X \times E$  such that  $f(x) = \pi(e)$ , and the map  $f^*\pi$  is the projection to the second factor restricted to said subspace.

**Example 3.1.14.** Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow X$  be a vector bundle. For any  $Y \subseteq X$  we have the vector bundle

$$\pi|_Y : \pi^{-1}(Y) \rightarrow Y,$$

which is defined as the pullback along the inclusion of  $Y$  into  $X$ .

rem:vb-restrictionOfBundles

**Remark 3.1.15.** We will often omit the notation of the projection and denote a vector bundle by its total space. The restriction  $\pi|_Y : \pi^{-1}(Y) \rightarrow Y$  is often denoted by  $E|_Y$ . The restriction may equivalently be defined by restricting the domain and codomain of the projection.

rem:vg-pullbackInducesBundleMap

**Remark 3.1.16.** Notice that this construction of the pullback  $f^*\pi : f^*(E) \rightarrow X$  is the simplest space to make the square commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^*(E) & \xrightarrow{\pi_2} & E \\ \downarrow f^*\pi & & \downarrow \pi \\ X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \end{array}$$

The notion of simplicity is captured by the universal property, that for any other vector bundle  $\tilde{\pi} : \tilde{E} \rightarrow X$  and function  $\tilde{f} : \tilde{E} \rightarrow E$  there exists a unique  $h : \tilde{E} \rightarrow f^*(E)$  (which is given by  $h(y) := (\tilde{\pi}(y), \tilde{f}(y))$ ) such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\tilde{E} & & \xrightarrow{\tilde{f}} & & E \\
\downarrow h & & & & \downarrow \pi \\
& f^*(E) & \xrightarrow{\pi_2} & & E \\
& \downarrow f^*\pi & & & \downarrow \pi \\
& X & \xrightarrow{f} & & Y
\end{array}$$

(Note: There is also a curved arrow from  $\tilde{E}$  to  $X$  labeled  $\tilde{\pi}$ .)

**Remark 3.1.17.** Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow X$  be a vector bundle. Then the space of sections  $\Gamma(E)$  is a (in general, infinite-dimensional)  $\mathbb{R}$ -vector space. Furthermore, and more relevant to the purposes of this thesis, we view  $\Gamma(E)$  (and  $\Gamma(U)$  for open subsets) as a  $C(X)$  (or  $C(U)$ ) module. The latter denotes the ring of continuous functions from  $E$  (or  $U$ ) to  $\mathbb{R}$ .

**Example 3.1.18.** For any smooth manifold  $M$  of dimension  $m$ , we can equip the union

$$TM := \bigsqcup_{p \in M} T_p M$$

with a topology, such that  $\pi : TM \rightarrow M$  defines a vector bundle which we call **tangent bundle**. For this we first define the trivialisations and then equip  $TM$  with a topology to make them homeomorphisms: Let  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart on  $M$ . If we denote the  $i$ -th coordinate function of  $\varphi$  by  $\varphi_i$  we can define the bijection

$$\tilde{\varphi} : \pi^{-1}(U) \rightarrow V \times \mathbb{R}^m, \quad \xi_p \mapsto \left( \varphi(p), \begin{pmatrix} \xi_p(\varphi_1) \\ \vdots \\ \xi_p(\varphi_m) \end{pmatrix} \right).$$

Now we declare a subset  $W \subseteq TM$  to be open, if and only if for all charts  $\varphi$  the set  $\tilde{\varphi}(W \cap \pi^{-1}(U)) \subset V \times \mathbb{R}^m$  is open. We can now extend and give meaning to the notation of the local basis vectors  $\partial_i(p) \in T_p M$ : For any chart  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  we have the local sections

$$\partial_i : U \rightarrow TM, \quad p \mapsto \partial_i(p).$$

Furthermore,  $TM$  is a  $2m$ -dimensional manifold. Using a smooth atlas on  $M$  yields a smooth atlas on  $TM$  making it a smooth manifold. Notice that the family  $(\partial_i)_i$  is a basis of the  $C(U)$ -module  $\Gamma(U)$ . This follows by expressing any section in local coordinates via  $\tilde{\varphi}$ .

Notice that  $TM$  as a bundle satisfies more than just the bundle definition: Taking two different charts induces two different local trivialisations. Transitioning between them is not just fibrewise linear, but also smooth. This is captured in the definition:

Henceforth we suppress the differentiable structure from the notation.

**Definition 3.1.19** (The Derivative). Let  $M$  and  $M'$  be smooth manifolds. We call a continuous function  $f : M \rightarrow M'$  **smooth**, if for all  $\varphi \in \mathfrak{A} \in \mathcal{C}$  and  $\varphi' \in \mathfrak{A}' \in \mathcal{C}'$  the maps

$$\varphi' \circ f \circ \varphi^{-1} : V \rightarrow V'$$



are smooth. A given smooth function induces a smooth map between the tangent bundles as manifolds as follows:

$$df : TM \rightarrow TM', df_p(\xi_p)(g_p) = \xi((g \circ f)_p)$$

Here,  $\xi_p \in T_p M$ ,  $g_p \in \mathcal{E}_p(M')$ . The function  $df$  is called the **derivative** or **pushforward** of  $f$ .

**Definition 3.1.20** (Smooth Vector Bundles). A **smooth vector bundle of rank  $r$**  is a surjection  $\pi : E \rightarrow M$  where the codomain (or base space) is a smooth manifold together with a family of continuous functions (or local trivialisations)

$$\Phi_i : \pi^{-1}(U_i) \rightarrow U_i \times \mathbb{R}^r$$

such that  $\bigcup_i U_i = M$  and for all overlapping  $U_i \cap U_j \neq \emptyset$ , the transition functions

$$\Phi_j \circ \Phi_i^{-1} : \pi^{-1}(U_i \cap U_j) \rightarrow (U_i \cap U_j) \times \mathbb{R}^r$$

are of the form

$$\Phi_j \circ \Phi_i^{-1}(p, v) = (p, g_{i,j}(v)), \quad \text{where} \quad g_{i,j} : (U_i \cap U_j) \rightarrow \text{GL}(r, \mathbb{R})$$

is smooth.

**Corollary 3.1.21.** A smooth vector bundle is a smooth manifold and also a vector bundle. The latter is ensured by the codomain of  $g_{i,j}$  which is also called the **structure group**. We can enforce structure on the bundle by reducing the structure group. As a preview: reducing it to  $\text{GL}^+(k, \mathbb{R})$  the linear maps with positive determinant means that we can induce the concept of orientations. Reducing it to  $\text{O}(k)$  lets us equip it with a Riemannian metric.

**Definition 3.1.22.** Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow M$  be a smooth vector bundle of rank  $r$  and let

$$\Phi : \pi^{-1}(U) \rightarrow U \times \mathbb{R}^r$$

be a local trivialisation. Then a section is called smooth if it is a smooth map of manifolds. A family of smooth local sections  $(s_1, \dots, s_r)$  with  $s_i \in \Gamma(U)$  is called a **local frame** if they form a basis of the  $C(U)$ -module  $\Gamma(U)$ . Such a family is obtained from  $\Phi$  by defining  $s_i(p) := \Phi^{-1}(p, e_i)$ . Similar, from a local frame we can obtain a local trivialisations by defining:

$$\Phi : \pi^{-1}(U) \rightarrow U \times \mathbb{R}^r, \quad v = \sum_{i=1}^r \lambda_i s_i(\pi(v)) \mapsto (\pi(v), \lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_r).$$

**Example 3.1.23.** The local trivialisations  $\partial_i$  of the tangent bundle of a smooth manifold  $M$  form a local frame and make the tangent bundle into a smooth vector bundle.

def:vb-frames  
FromTrivialis  
ations

def:vb-homomorphismBundle

**Definition 3.1.24** (Homomorphism Bundle). Let  $W, V$  be vector spaces and  $E = V \times X$ ,  $F = W \times X$  the product bundles over  $X$ . Now any bundle homomorphism  $\varphi : E \rightarrow F$  determines a map  $\Phi : X \rightarrow \text{hom}(V, W)$  by sending  $x \mapsto \varphi_x$ . With respect to the compact-open topology, this  $\Phi$  is continuous. Furthermore, a continuous map  $\Phi : X \rightarrow \text{hom}(V, W)$  determines a bundle homomorphism  $\varphi : E \rightarrow F$ .

*Proof.* Let  $\{e_i\}$  and  $\{f_i\}$  be bases of  $V$  and  $W$ . Then each  $\Phi(x)$  is a matrix  $\Phi_{i,j}(x)$ , such that:

$$\Phi(x)e_i = \sum_j \Phi_{i,j}(x)f_j.$$

Now  $\Phi$  is continuous if and only if  $\Phi_{i,j}$  is continuous. Since  $\varphi(x, v) = (x, \Phi(x)v)$  this is equivalent to  $\varphi$  being continuous.  $\square$

thm:vb-isomorphicVectorBundles

**Lemma 3.1.25** (Isomorphic Vector Bundles). *Let  $E$  and  $F$  be vector bundles and  $\varphi : E \rightarrow F$  be a homomorphism. Then  $\varphi$  is an isomorphism if and only if all  $\varphi_x$  are isomorphisms.*

*Proof.* To show that it is an isomorphism we need a continuous inverse, equivalently, we need to show that  $\varphi$  is a homeomorphism. First of all we can deduce, that  $\varphi$  is bijective: Assume it wasn't injective, then there would be a fibre in which  $\varphi_x$  is not injective. Assume that it wasn't surjective. Then there would be a  $w \in F$  that has no preimage which means that in the fiber containing  $w$  there is no isomorphism. Thus, there is a unique inverse and it remains to verify that it is continuous, which is a local condition. Therefore we can assume that  $E$  and  $F$  are product bundles. Then we have a continuous map  $\Phi : X \rightarrow \text{Hom}(V, W)$ . Furthermore, since all  $\varphi_x$  are isomorphisms, we can restrict the image to  $\text{Iso}(V, W)$  which is an open subset of  $\text{Hom}(V, W)$ . Now we can define the map  $x \mapsto \Phi(x)^{-1}$  which is continuous since taking inverses is continuous. By the corollary above, we obtain a continuous map  $\psi : F \rightarrow E$  by sending  $(x, w) \mapsto (x, \Phi(x)^{-1}(w))$ , which is the inverse.  $\square$

**Example 3.1.26.** Let  $M$  be a smooth manifold of dimension  $m$ ,  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  a chart and  $\tilde{\varphi} : TU \rightarrow V \times \mathbb{R}^m$  be the corresponding bundle chart. Then it follows from the lemma, that  $TU$  is isomorphic to  $V \times \mathbb{R}^m$ . This is verified by observing that  $\partial_i(p)$  is a basis of  $T_p U$  for all  $p \in U$ . In this case  $\tilde{\varphi}(\partial_i) = e_i$  giving us isomorphisms in each fiber.

Now we want to construct new bundles from old ones. There are many operations to construct new vector spaces such as the tensor product, direct sum, Hom-Spaces and many more. Instead of individually proving that those operations applied fiberwise yield new bundles, we subsume these operations within the following definition:

**Definition 3.1.27** (Continuous Functor). Let  $T$  be a covariant endofunctor in the category of finite-dimensional vector spaces. We call  $T$  a **continuous functor**, if for all  $V, W$  the map  $T : \text{hom}(V, W) \rightarrow \text{hom}(T(V), T(W))$  is continuous. All vector spaces

are given the topology induced by their isomorphism to real Euclidean space. If  $E$  is a vector bundle we define the set:

$$T(E) := \bigcup_{x \in X} T(E_x).$$

Now we want to equip this with a topology such that  $T(E)$  is a bundle over the same base space as  $E$ .

def: vb-constr  
uctingNewBund  
les

**Definition 3.1.28** (Constructing new bundles). We start by assuming that  $E = X \times V$ . In that case we define the topology on  $T(E)$  as the product topology  $X \times T(V)$ . Now suppose that  $F = X \times W$  is another product bundle and  $f : E \rightarrow F$  is a homomorphism. Let  $\Phi : X \rightarrow \text{hom}(V, W)$  be the corresponding map. Then  $T\Phi : X \rightarrow \text{hom}(T(V), T(W))$  is continuous by assumption. Thereby,  $T(\varphi) : X \times T(V) \rightarrow X \times T(W)$  is continuous. If  $\varphi$  is an isomorphism, then  $T(\varphi)$  is also an isomorphism. That follows because it is continuous and an isomorphism fibrewise.

Now assume that  $E$  is trivial. Then we can choose an isomorphism  $\alpha : E \rightarrow X \times V$  and induce a topology on  $T(E)$  by pulling it back via  $T(\alpha) : T(E) \rightarrow X \times T(V)$ . This topology does not depend on  $\alpha$  by the above. For general vector bundles we do this construction locally.

If  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  is continuous, there is a natural isomorphism

$$f^*T(E) \cong T f^*(E)$$

This construction is carried out in detail by Atiyah in [Ati89, Chapter 1.2] and can be generalised for continuous functors with several variables both co- and contravariant. Hence this procedure gives us for vector bundles  $E$  and  $F$  over the same base space the new bundles:

- (i)  $E \oplus F$ , their direct sum
- (ii)  $E \otimes F$ , their tensor product
- (iii)  $\text{Hom}(E, F)$
- (iv)  $E^*$ , the dual bundle of  $E$
- (v)  $\Lambda^i(E)$  the  $i$ -th exterior power

and by the natural isomorphism we have natural isomorphisms:

- (i)  $E \oplus F \cong F \oplus E$
- (ii)  $E \otimes F \cong F \otimes E$
- (iii)  $E \otimes (F \oplus F') \cong E \otimes F \oplus E \otimes F'$
- (iv)  $\text{Hom}(E, F) \cong E^* \otimes F$

cor:vb-sectionsIntoHom

**Corollary 3.1.29.** Let  $\pi_E : E \rightarrow X$  and  $\pi_F : F \rightarrow X$  be two vector bundles over  $X$ . Then, the space  $\Gamma(\text{Hom}(E, F))$  can be identified with the space of bundle morphisms  $\text{hom}(E, F)$  since for any section  $s : X \rightarrow \text{Hom}(E, F)$  we can define the bundle homomorphism  $\tilde{s} : E \rightarrow F$  by sending  $v \mapsto s_{\pi_E(v)}(v)$ . This is a homomorphism since  $\pi_F(\tilde{s}(v)) = \pi_E(v)$ .

**Example 3.1.30** (Cotangent bundle). Let  $M$  be a smooth manifold of dimension  $m$ . Then we can define the **cotangent bundle**  $T^*M$  to be the dual of the tangent bundle. A local frame of said bundle is given by the fiberwise dual of the frame  $(\partial_i)$ . Sections into the tangent bundle are called **vector fields** and sections into the cotangent bundle are called **one-forms**.

def:vb-linear-identification

**Definition 3.1.31.** Let  $V$  be a linear manifold (i.e. a finite-dimensional vector space). Then for any  $v \in V$  we have the canonical maps

$$R_v : V \rightarrow T_v V$$

$$x \mapsto \left( f_v \mapsto \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Big|_{t=0} f(v + tx) \right)$$

Let  $L : V \rightarrow V$  be a linear map viewed as a smooth map between manifolds. Then we have the identity:

$$dL_v \circ R_v = R_{L(v)} \circ L.$$

This is proved by a short calculation:

$$\left( dL_v(R_v(x)) \right) (f_{L(v)}) = R_v(x) (f \circ L) = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Big|_{t=0} f \circ L(v + tx) = \underbrace{\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Big|_{t=0} f(L(v) + tL(x))}_{=R_{L(v)} \circ L(x)}$$

Now let  $v, v' \in V$ . Then we have the translation

$$tr_{v,v'} : V \rightarrow V; \quad x \mapsto (x + (v' - v))$$

This allows us to relate  $R_v$  and  $R_{v'}$  as follows:

$$\left( dtr_{v,v'}|_v (R_v(x)) \right) (f_{v'}) = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Big|_{t=0} (f \circ tr_{v,v'}(v + tx)) = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Big|_{t=0} (f(v' + tx)) = R_{v'}(x)(f_{v'}).$$

Hence:

$$R_{v'} = dtr_{v,v'} \circ R_v.$$

The **linear identification** is the map  $Q$  given on the whole tangent bundle:

$$Q : TV \rightarrow V; \quad \xi_p \mapsto R_p^{-1}(\xi_p),$$

and satisfies for any linear  $L : v \rightarrow V$

$$Q \circ dL = L \circ Q.$$

cor:vb-vector  
FieldsTakeFun  
ctions

**Corollary 3.1.32.** Let  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be smooth. Then we can interpret  $df$  as a one-form. To be precise, let  $Q : T\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  denote the linear identification with respect to the identity on  $\mathbb{R}$ . For  $v \in \Gamma(TM)$  we have

$$(Q \circ df)(v) = v(f)$$

Here on the right side,  $f$  denotes a map  $p \mapsto f_p$  such that  $v(f)(p) := v_p(f_p)$  is well defined. We retain this notation so that vector fields can take functions as an input.

*Proof.* Let  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart of  $M$ . We prove this by showing it for the local sections  $\partial_i$  and the general case follows by  $C(U)$ -linearity, since those sections form a local frame. Now let  $g_p \in \mathcal{E}_p(\mathbb{R})$  and  $\varphi(p) = x_0$ . Then

$$df_p(\partial_i(p))(g_p) = \partial_i((g \circ f)_p) = \frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} \Big|_{x_0} (g \circ f \circ \varphi^{-1}) = \frac{\partial}{\partial x_{f_p(p)}} (g_p) \cdot \partial_i(p)(f_p)$$

Hence, applying  $Q$  to the calculation yields  $(Q \circ df)(v) = v(f)$ .  $\square$

**Definition 3.1.33** (A Metric). Let  $M$  be a smooth manifold. A section  $g \in \Gamma(T^*M \otimes T^*M)$  into the tensor product of the dual tangent bundle with itself is a **Riemannian metric** if the following are satisfied for all  $p \in M$ :

1.  $g$  is **non-degenerate**, meaning if for a  $v_p \in T_pM$  we have  $g_p(v_p, w_p) = 0$  for all  $w_p \in T_pM$  then  $v_p = 0$ .
2.  $g$  is **symmetric**, meaning  $g_p(v_p, w_p) = g_p(w_p, v_p)$  for all  $v_p, w_p \in T_pM$ .
3.  $g$  is **positive definite**, meaning that  $g_p(v_p, v_p) \geq 0$  for all  $v_p$  with equality only for  $v_p = 0$ .

We call a tuple  $(M, g)$  a **Riemannian manifold**.

**Remark 3.1.34.** Equipping a smooth manifold  $M$  of dimension  $m$  with a Riemannian metric is equivalent to reducing the structure group of the tangent bundle from  $GL(m)$  to  $O(m)$ . To be precise: A Riemannian metric  $g$  lets us canonically choose an atlas with structure group  $O(m)$  and an atlas with such a structure group lets us canonically choose a Riemannian metric.

*Proof.* We start by assuming that we have an atlas with structure group  $O(m)$ . In Definition 3.1.22 we saw that a covering of local trivializations is equivalent to a covering of smooth frames. Now in a single trivialization

$$\Phi : \pi^{-1}(U) \cong TU \rightarrow U \times \mathbb{R}^m$$

we call the projection to the  $\mathbb{R}^m$ -part (the second factor)  $\pi_2$  and define

$$\begin{aligned} g : U &\rightarrow T^*U \otimes T^*U \\ p &\mapsto \begin{aligned} &g_p^\Phi : T_pU \times T_pU \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ &(\nu_p, \xi_p) \mapsto g_p^\Phi(\nu_p, \xi_p) := \pi_2(\Phi(\nu_p)) \cdot \pi_2(\Phi(\xi_p)), \end{aligned} \end{aligned}$$

where  $\cdot$  denotes the standard scalar product. This gives us locally a Riemannian metric. If we do this for all trivializations we have to make sure, that the result is well defined. So assume that two trivializations  $\Phi$  and  $\Psi$  overlap in  $V$ . The structure group is  $O(m)$ ,  $\Phi = R\Psi$  for some function

$$R : V \rightarrow O(m).$$

Let  $p$  be in said overlapping and  $(\nu_p, \xi_p)$  be from  $T_p M \times T_p M$ . Then since  $R$  is orthogonal we can calculate the independence from the trivialization:

$$g_p^\Phi(\nu_p, \xi_p) = \pi_2(R\Psi(\nu_p)) \cdot \pi_2(R\Psi(\xi_p)) = \pi_2(\Psi(\nu_p)) \cdot \pi_2(\Psi(\xi_p)) = g_p^\Psi(\nu_p, \xi_p).$$

To get an orthonormal atlas from a smooth one given a Riemannian metric, we start by building a covering of local frames from the trivialisations. We then apply Gram-Schmidt to the local frames to get orthonormal frames. Now a covering of orthonormal frames gives a covering of trivializations, where the structure group consists of basis changes between orthonormal bases and hence is  $O(m)$ .  $\square$

**Definition 3.1.35** (The Gradient). Assume that  $(M, g)$  is a smooth manifold together with a Riemannian metric. Let  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a smooth function and  $Q : T\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  the linear identification. We define its **gradient** to be a vector field  $\text{grad}(f) \in \Gamma(TM)$  such that for any vector field  $V$ :

$$Q \circ df(V) = g(\text{grad}(f), V).$$

Notice how the non-degeneracy of  $g$  ensures existence and uniqueness.

**Definition 3.1.36.** Let  $(M, g)$  be a Riemannian manifold and  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart. We define the smooth functions  $g_{ij} : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  to be:

$$g_{ij}(p) = g_p(\partial_i(p), \partial_j(p)).$$

Then if two vector fields  $v, w$  over  $U$  are given with  $v = \sum v_i \partial_i$  and  $w = \sum w_i \partial_i$  we can calculate the metric locally:

$$g(v, w) = \sum_{i,j} g_{ij} v_i w_j : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

Furthermore, we can invert the matrices  $(g_{ij}(p))_{ij}$  for all  $p$  (which is a smooth procedure as can be seen by the construction via Cramer's rule) to get smooth functions

$$g^{ij} : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

$$p \mapsto g^{ij}(p) = \left( (g_{kl}(p))_{kl}^{-1} \right)_{ij}$$

**Remark 3.1.37.** Due to the rare appearance of big summations with vectors and co-vectors in this work, we omit the Einstein summation convention and assign all coordinate entries lower indices.

def:vb-localD  
escriptionOfg  
radientGij

lem:vb-localD  
escriptionOfG  
radient

**Lemma 3.1.38** (Local Description of the Gradient). *Let  $(M, g)$  be a smooth Riemannian manifold of dimension  $m$  and  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart. Then the gradient has the local form:*

$$\text{grad}(f) = \sum_{i,j} g^{ij} (\partial_i(f)) \cdot \partial_j.$$

*Proof.* Assume that  $v, w \in \Gamma(TU)$  such that  $v = \sum_i v_i \partial_i$  and  $w = \sum_i w_i \partial_i$  (Here  $v_i$  and  $w_i$  are smooth functions  $U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ ). Then  $g(v, w) = \sum_{i,j} g_{ij} v_i w_j$ . Suppose that  $\text{grad}(f) = \sum_j G^j \partial_j$  and  $Q$  is the linear identification  $T\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  in each tangent space. Then by definition of the gradient and corollary 3.1.32 we have:

$$\partial_j(f) = Q \circ df(\partial_j) = g(\text{grad}(f), \partial_j) = g\left(\sum_i G^i \partial_i, \partial_j\right) = \sum_i g_{ij} G^i$$

Reading this as a pointwise matrix product:

$$(G^1, \dots, G^m)(g_{ij}) = (\partial_1(f), \dots, \partial_m(f))$$

which gives  $(G^1, \dots, G^m) = (\partial_1(f), \dots, \partial_m(f))(g^{ij})$ .

But then we can conclude that  $G^j = \sum_i g^{ij} \partial_i(f)$ . □

**Definition 3.1.39** (A Dynamical System). Let  $M$  be a smooth manifold. A **dynamical system on  $M$**  (sometimes also called a **flow on  $M$** ) is given by a smooth map  $\varphi : \Omega \rightarrow M$  such that:

1.  $\{0\} \times M \subseteq \Omega \subseteq \mathbb{R} \times M$  open, and for any  $p \in M$  the set  $I(p) := \pi_1(\Omega \cap \mathbb{R} \times \{p\})$  is connected. ( $\pi_1$  is the projection onto the first factor)
2. For all  $p \in M$  and  $t \in I(p)$  we have that  $s \in I(\varphi(t, p))$  if and only if  $s + t \in I(p)$ . Then we have:

$$\varphi(s, (\varphi(t, p))) = \varphi(s + t, p)$$

3. For all  $p$  we require  $\varphi(0, p) = p$ .

We will write  $\varphi_t(p) := \varphi(t, p)$  to keep the notation manageable. If for all  $p$   $I(p) = \mathbb{R}$  we call the system **global**.

**Corollary 3.1.40.** For a global dynamical system  $\varphi$  on a smooth manifold  $M$  the map

$$\rho : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \text{Diff}(M), \quad t \mapsto \varphi_t$$

is a homomorphism. To verify well-definedness notice how for all  $t \in \mathbb{R}$ ,  $\varphi_{-t}$  is an inverse of  $\varphi_t$ . The map  $\rho$  is called a **one-parameter group of diffeomorphisms**.

**Definition 3.1.41** (Vector Field of a Dynamical System). Let  $\varphi : \Omega \rightarrow M$  be a dynamical system on a smooth manifold  $M$ . For a chart  $\psi : U \rightarrow V$  of  $M$  we have the chart  $\text{id} \times \psi$  of  $\Omega$ . For this chart we denote the associated local frame by  $(\partial_t, \partial_1, \dots, \partial_m)$ . Using this we define the mapping

$$\begin{aligned} M &\rightarrow TM \\ p &\mapsto X(p) := d\varphi(\partial_t(0, p)) \end{aligned}$$

and call it the **associated vector field**. This is in fact a smooth vector field.

**Definition 3.1.42** (Dynamical System of a Vector Field). Let  $X \in \Gamma(TM)$  be a global vector field on the smooth manifold  $M$ . Then we call a dynamical system  $\varphi$  on  $M$  the **associated dynamical system** to  $X$ , if for all  $t \in \mathbb{R}$  and  $x \in M$

$$d\varphi(\partial_t(t, x)) = X(\varphi_t(x)).$$

**Remark 3.1.43.** Regarding the left-hand side of the definition  $d\varphi(\partial_t(t, x))$  we could also differentiate the map

$$t \mapsto \varphi_t(x),$$

for fixed  $x$  at  $t$  and evaluate this at the constant vector field  $t \mapsto R_t(1) \in T_t\mathbb{R}$  from definition 3.1.31.

These two constructions are mutually inverse, giving the following theorem:

**Theorem 3.1.44.** *Let  $M$  be a smooth manifold. Then there is a one-to-one correspondence between global dynamical systems and vector fields given by the constructions above.*



## 4 Complex K Theory

### 4.1 Mathematical Goals

**Theorem 4.1.1** (The Theorems and Mathematical Structures). • *Definition of The K- Functor*

- *Cohomology structures*
  - *Additivity (pointed sum)*
  - *Long exact sequences*
  - *Excision*

### 4.2 Classification of Vector Bundles

The first goal is to classify all vector bundles over sufficiently nice spaces. The latter refers to spaces admitting partitions of unity for which Tietze's extension theorem holds. For simplicity we just consider compact spaces. Along the way we will discover that the set of isomorphism classes of vector bundles is a homotopy invariance.

Before we go back to the analytical reals, we will further develop the theory of vector bundles:

**Definition 4.2.1.** For a topological space  $X$  we define  $\text{Vect}_n$  to be the set of isomorphism classes of complex vector bundles of rank  $n$  and  $\text{Vect}(X)$  to be the set of isomorphism classes of complex vector bundles of any rank. By declaring  $\text{Vect}(f) = f^*$  to be the pullback we get a contravariant functor  $\text{Vect}$  from **CGWH** to **Set**. We can equip the set  $\text{Vect}(X)$  with the direct sum and tensor product operation. It is then easy to see that these operations descend to isomorphism classes and hence we get an abelian semi ring  $(\text{Vect}(X), \oplus, \otimes)$  (abelian semigroup with associative and distributive multiplication). In fact we even get a contravariant functor from **CGWH** to the category of abelian semirings.

lem:kTheo-sec  
tionExtension

**Lemma 4.2.2.** *Let  $X$  be a compact space,  $Y \subseteq X$  a closed subspace and  $E$  a vector bundle over  $X$ . Then any section  $s : Y \rightarrow E|_Y$  can be extended to a global section of  $X$ .*

*Proof.* For a detailed proof see Chapter 1.4 of [\[Ati89\]](#)<sup>[atiyah1989k]</sup>. The general argument however is easy to follow: By Tietze's extension theorem we can extend the section to around every  $x \in X$ . By compactness we can pick finitely many of those extensions. Now using a partition of unity with respect to their domains we can build the sum of all the extensions to get a well defined global one.  $\square$

cor:kTheo-iso  
morphismExten  
sion

**Corollary 4.2.3.** Let  $Y$  be a closed subspace of a compact space  $X$ , and let  $E, F$  be bundles over  $X$ . If  $f : E|_Y \rightarrow F|_Y$  is an isomorphism, then there is an open neighbourhood  $U \supset Y$  and an extension  $f : E|_U \rightarrow F|_U$  which is an isomorphism.

*Proof.* By corollary 3.1.29 we can view  $f$  as a section into the bundle  $\text{Hom}(E|_Y, F|_Y)$ , which can be extended to a global one in  $\text{Hom}(E, F)$ . Let  $U$  be the open set for which the section maps to isomorphisms. Since  $U$  contains  $Y$  this yields the require extension.  $\square$

thm:kTheo-hom  
otopyInvarian  
ce

**Theorem 4.2.4** (Homotopy Invariance of the Pullback). *Let  $X, Y$  be two compact spaces,  $I = [0, 1]$ , and*

$$f : Y \times I \rightarrow X$$

*be a homotopy. For a fixed  $t \in I$ , we define the function  $f_t : Y \rightarrow X$ ,  $f_t(y) = f(t, y)$ . Let  $\pi : E \rightarrow X$  be a vector bundle. Then*

$$f_0^*(E) \cong f_1^*(E).$$

*Proof.* Consider the following two vector bundles over  $Y \times I$ :

$$f^*E \quad \text{and} \quad \pi_1^* f_t^* E,$$

where  $\pi_1 : Y \times I \rightarrow Y$  denotes the projection and  $t \in I$ . Since the restriction is by definition the pullback along the inclusion  $i : Y \times \{t\} \rightarrow Y \times I$ . The equality of the two maps:

$$f \circ i = f_t \circ \pi_1 \circ i : Y \times \{t\} \rightarrow X$$

together with the functoriality gives us an isomorphism

$$\Phi : f^*E|_{Y \times \{t\}} \rightarrow \pi_1^* f_t^* E|_{Y \times \{t\}}.$$

By Corollary 4.2.3 we can extend the isomorphism for some open neighbourhood of  $Y \times \{t\}$  and by the product topology we can deduce that there exists a  $\delta_t$  such that  $U$  contains the thickened line  $Y \times (t - \delta_t, t + \delta_t)$ . The isomorphism class of  $f^*E|_{Y \times \{t\}}$  as a bundle over  $Y$  is locally constant in  $t$ : Let  $0 < \varepsilon < \delta$  and  $r \in I$ . Then define the inclusions

$$\begin{array}{ccc} i_t : Y & \rightarrow & Y \times \{t\} \subseteq Y \times I \\ y & \mapsto & (y, t) \end{array} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} i_{t+\varepsilon} : Y & \rightarrow & Y \times (t - \delta_t, t + \delta_t) \\ y & \mapsto & (y, t + \varepsilon) \end{array}$$

Then we have the identities  $f_t = f \circ i_t$  and  $\pi_1 \circ i_{t+\varepsilon} = \text{id}_Y$  and we can calculate:

$$f_{t+\varepsilon}^* E = i_{t+\varepsilon}^* f^* E = i_{t+\varepsilon}^* \pi_1^* f_t^* E = (f_t \circ \pi_1 \circ i_{t+\varepsilon})^* E = f_t^* E.$$

Finally, since  $I$  is connected, any locally constant map from  $I$  is globally constant and therefore  $f_0^* E \cong f_1^* E$ .  $\square$

lem:kTheo-con  
tractibleBund  
lesAreTivial

**Corollary 4.2.5.** 1. If  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  is a homotopy equivalence,  $f^* : (Y) \rightarrow (X)$  is a semiring isomorphism.

2. If  $X$  is contractible, every bundle over  $X$  is trivial and  $(X) \cong \mathbb{N}_0$

def:kTheo-tri  
vialization

**Definition 4.2.6** (Trivialization of a Vector Bundle). Let  $Y$  be a closed subspace of  $X$ ,  $E$  a vector bundle over  $X$  and  $\alpha : E|_Y \rightarrow Y \times V$  be an isomorphism. Then we call  $\alpha$  **trivialisation of  $E$  over  $Y$** .

lem:kTheo-tri  
vialisationDe  
finesABundle

**Lemma 4.2.7.** *A trivialization  $\alpha$  of a bundle  $E$  over  $Y \subseteq X$  defines a bundle  $E/\alpha$  over  $X/Y$ . The isomorphism class of  $E/\alpha$  depends only on the homotopy class of  $\alpha$ .*

*Proof.* We define the bundle  $E/\alpha$  as follows: Let  $\pi_2 : Y \times V \rightarrow V$  denote the projection and define an equivalence relation on  $E|_Y$  by

$$e \sim e' \Leftrightarrow \pi_2 \alpha(e) = \pi_2 \alpha(e').$$

We extend this relation by the identity on  $E|_{X \setminus Y}$  and we define  $E/\alpha$  to denote the quotient space of  $E$  defined by that relation. To see why this is a bundle we need to check the local triviality only around the base point  $Y/Y$  of  $X/Y$ . This follows from the fact that by Corollary 4.2.3 we can extend  $\alpha$  to an isomorphism  $\tilde{\alpha} : E|_U \rightarrow U \times V$ . Then  $\tilde{\alpha}$  induces an isomorphism

$$E/\alpha|_{U/Y} \cong (U/Y) \times V$$

proving the local triviality. Now for the homotopy invariance of said bundle suppose that  $\alpha_0$  and  $\alpha_1$  are homotopic trivializations of  $E$  over  $Y$ . This means that we have a trivialization  $\beta$  of  $E \times I$  over  $Y \times I \subset X \times I$  that induces the  $\alpha_i$  at the endpoints. Let  $f : (X/Y) \times I \rightarrow (X \times I)/(Y \times I)$  be the natural map. Then  $f^*((E \times I)/\beta)$  is a bundle on  $(X/Y) \times I$  whose restriction to  $(X/Y) \times \{i\}$  is  $E/\alpha_i$  ( $i = 0, 1$ ). Hence by the homotopy invariance of the pullback (Theorem 4.2.4) we have

$$E/\alpha_0 \cong E/\alpha_1.$$

□

cor:kTheo-tri  
vializationIs  
RightInverse

**Corollary 4.2.8.** The trivialization acts as a right inverse of the pullback along the collaps: If we call  $f : X \rightarrow X/Y$  the collaps, and  $fE$  can be trivialized over  $Y$  via  $\alpha$ , then

$$f^*(E/\alpha) \cong E.$$

*Proof.* Intuitively this is clear, as the pullback along the collaps builds a bundle, that is trivial over  $Y$  and agrees with  $E$  outside of  $Y$ . To proof the statement we will construct a bundle map, that is an isomorphism in each fibre: Let  $q : E \rightarrow E/\alpha$  denote the quotient map from the construction and let  $\pi_E : E \rightarrow X$ ,  $\pi_{E/\alpha} : E/\alpha \rightarrow X/Y$  be the bundle projections. By construction of  $E/\alpha$  we have  $\pi_{E/\alpha} \circ q = f \circ \pi_E$ , so

$$\Phi : E \rightarrow f^*(E/\alpha), \quad \Phi(e) = (\pi_E(e), q(e))$$

is a well-defined bundle morphism. We show  $\Phi$  is a fiberwise linear isomorphism, and hence a bundle isomorphism by Lemma 3.1.25.

*Case  $x \notin Y$ :* Here the equivalence relation defining  $E/\alpha$  restricts to the identity on  $E_x$ , so

$$q_x : E_x \xrightarrow{\cong} (E/\alpha)_{f(x)} = (E/\alpha)_x$$

is a linear isomorphism.

*Case  $x \in Y$ :* By definition of the equivalence relation, two points  $e, e' \in E_x$  are identified with  $\pi_2 \alpha(e) = \pi_2 \alpha(e') \in V$ , and all fibers  $E_x$  ( $x \in Y$ ) are glued to the single fiber  $(E/\alpha)_{y_0} \cong V$  over the basepoint  $y_0 = Y/Y$ . Hence

$$q_x = \pi_2 \circ \alpha_x : E_x \rightarrow V = (E/\alpha)_{y_0},$$

where  $\alpha_x : E_x \rightarrow V$  is the (linear) restriction of  $\alpha$  to the fiber over  $x$ . Since  $\alpha_x$  is a linear isomorphism, so is  $q_x$ .

Thus  $\Phi$  is a bundle morphism which is a linear isomorphism on every fiber.  $\square$

lem:kTheo-col  
lapsingOfCont  
ractableSubsp  
ace

**Lemma 4.2.9.** *Let  $Y \subseteq X$  be a closed contractible subspace of a compact space  $X$ . Then*

$$f : X \rightarrow X/Y \text{ induces a semiring isomorphism } f^* : \text{Vect}(X/Y) \rightarrow \text{Vect}(X).$$

*Proof.* Since  $Y$  is contractible,  $E|_Y$  is trivial and thereby a trivialization  $\alpha : E|_Y \rightarrow Y \times V$  exists. Two such trivializations only differ by the automorphism of  $Y \times V$  which in turn corresponds to a map  $Y \rightarrow \text{GL}(V) \cong \text{GL}_{\text{rank}(E)}(\mathbb{C})$ . Now since  $Y$  is contractible those two maps factor (up to homotopy) over any one point  $y \in Y$  and are thereby homotopically equivalent to the constant map. Finally since  $\text{GL}_{\text{rank}(E)}(\mathbb{C})$  is connected all constant maps are homotopically equivalent. Thereby  $\alpha$  is unique up to homotopy. By Lemma 4.2.7 the isomorphism class of  $E/\alpha$  only depends on the homotopy class of  $\alpha$  we have a well defined map

$$\text{Vect}(X) \rightarrow \text{Vect}(X/Y),$$

which in turn is an inverse of  $f^*$  concluding the proof.  $\square$

lem:kTheo-col  
lapsingOfCont  
ractableSubsp  
ace

**Lemma 4.2.10.** *Let  $Y \subseteq X$  be a closed contractible subspace of a compact space  $X$ . Then*

$$f : X \rightarrow X/Y \text{ induces a semiring isomorphism } f^* : \text{Vect}(X/Y) \rightarrow \text{Vect}(X).$$

*Proof.* Since  $Y$  is contractible,  $E|_Y$  is trivial and thereby a trivialization  $\alpha : E|_Y \rightarrow Y \times V$  exists. Two such trivializations only differ by the automorphism of  $Y \times V$  which in turn corresponds to a map  $Y \rightarrow \text{GL}(V) \cong \text{GL}_{\text{rank}(E)}(\mathbb{C})$ . Now since  $Y$  is contractible those two maps factor (up to homotopy) over any one point  $y \in Y$  and are thereby homotopically equivalent to the constant map. Finally since  $\text{GL}_{\text{rank}(E)}(\mathbb{C})$  is connected all constant maps are homotopically equivalent. Thereby  $\alpha$  is unique up to homotopy. By Lemma 4.2.7 the isomorphism class of  $E/\alpha$  only depends on the homotopy class of  $\alpha$  we have a well defined map

$$\text{Vect}(X) \rightarrow \text{Vect}(X/Y),$$

which in turn is an inverse of  $f^*$  concluding the proof.  $\square$

def:kTheo-glu  
ingAndClutchi  
ng

**Definition 4.2.11** (Gluing and Clutching of Vector Bundles). Let

$$X = X_1 \cup X_2, \quad A = X_1 \cap X_2,$$

and all be compact spaces. Assume that  $E_i$  is a vector bundle over  $X_i$  and  $\varphi : E_1|_A \rightarrow E_2|_A$  is an isomorphism. Then we define a vector bundle  $E_1 \cap_\varphi E_2$  on  $X$  as follows: We topologize the space  $E_1 \cup_\varphi E_2$  as the quotient of  $E_1 + E_2 / \sim$ , where  $\sim$  is the identification of points with their image under  $\varphi$ . Identifying  $X$  with  $X_1 + X_2$  in the quotient space we get the natural projection  $p : E_1 \cap_\varphi E_2 \rightarrow X$  and the fibers have a natural vector space structure. It remains to show that this is locally trivial. This is obvious outside of  $A$  so let  $a \in A$  and  $V_1$  be a closed neighbourhood of  $a$  in  $X_1$  such that  $E_1|_{V_1}$  is trivial giving us the isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \theta_1 : E_1|_{V_1} &\rightarrow V_1 \times \mathbb{C}^n \\ \theta_1^A : E_1|_{V_1 \cap A} &\rightarrow (V_1 \cap A) \times \mathbb{C}^n \end{aligned}$$

Finally, define

$$\theta_2^A : E_2|_{V_1 \cap A} \rightarrow (V_1 \cap A) \times \mathbb{C}^n$$

by composition  $\theta_1^A \circ \varphi^{-1}$ . Let  $V_2$  be a neighborhood of  $a$  in  $X_2$  such that

$$\theta_2 : E_2|_{V_2} \rightarrow V_2 \times \mathbb{C}^n$$

is an extension of  $\theta_2^A$ . This extension exists again by the extending the section into the homomorphism bundle corresponding to the isomorphism  $\theta_2^A$ . Finally  $\theta_1$  and  $\theta_2$  defines a well defined isomorphism

$$\theta_1 \cap_\varphi \theta_2 : E_1 \cap_\varphi E_2 \rightarrow (V_1 \cap V_2) \times \mathbb{C}^n.$$

This proves the local triviality.

We call such a triple  $(E_1, E_2, \varphi)$  a **clutching datum** and  $\varphi$  the **transition function**.

cor:kTheo-ele  
mentaryProper  
tiesGluingAnd  
Clutching

**Corollary 4.2.12** (Elementary Properties of the Gluing and Clutching Construction). Elementary properties of the gluing and clutching construction are:

1. If  $E$  is a bundle over  $X$ , then the identity defines an isomorphism and

$$E_1 \cup_{\text{id}_A} E_2 \cong E.$$

2. If  $\beta_i : E_i \rightarrow E'_i$  are isomorphisms on  $X_i$  and  $\varphi' \beta_1 = \beta_2 \varphi$ , then

$$E_1 \cup_\varphi E_2 \cong E'_1 \cup_{\varphi'} E'_2.$$

3. If  $(E_i, \varphi)$  and  $(E'_i, \varphi')$  are two "clutching data" on  $X_i$ , then

$$\begin{aligned} (E_1 \cup_\varphi E_2) \oplus (E'_1 \cup_{\varphi'} E'_2) &\cong E_1 \oplus E'_1 \bigcup_{\varphi \oplus \varphi'} E_2 \oplus E'_2, \\ (E_1 \cup_\varphi E_2) \otimes (E'_1 \cup_{\varphi'} E'_2) &\cong E_1 \otimes E'_1 \bigcup_{\varphi \otimes \varphi'} E_2 \otimes E'_2, \\ (E_1 \cup_\varphi E_2)^* &\cong E_1^* \bigcup_{(\varphi^*)^{-1}} E_2^*. \end{aligned}$$

$(-)^*$  denotes the dual here.

lem:kTheo-hom  
otopyInvariant  
ceClutchingFu  
nction

**Lemma 4.2.13.** *The isomorphism class of  $E_1 \cup_{\varphi} E_2$  depends only on the homotopy class of the isomorphism  $\varphi : E_1|_A \rightarrow E_2|_A$ .*

*Proof.* A homotopy of isomorphisms is a map

$$\Phi : E_1|_A \times I \rightarrow E_2|_A ,$$

such that for all  $t$  the map

$$\Phi_t : E_1|_A \rightarrow E_2|_A \quad \Phi_t(\xi) := \Phi(\xi, t)$$

is a bundle isomorphism. We can encode this  $\Phi$  into a bundle isomorphism as follows: Let  $\pi : X \times I \rightarrow X$  be the projection. Then elements  $\xi \in \pi^* E_1$  are by definition 3.1.13 of the form  $\xi_{x,t} = ((x, t), \xi_x) \in (\pi^* E_1)_{x,t}$ . With this notation define the bundle isomorphism:

$$\Psi : \pi^*(E_1)|_{A \times I} \rightarrow \pi^*(E_2)|_{A \times I} , \quad \Psi(\xi_{x,t}) := ((x, t), \Phi_t(\xi_x))$$

This is a bundle isomorphism, since  $\Phi_t$  is one. Now denote the inclusion

$$i_t : X \rightarrow X \times I, \quad i_t(x) := (x, t),$$

and notice that the pullback along  $i_t$  is the same as restricting to  $X \times \{t\}$ .

With those definitions it is clear by the construction of the gluing, that

$$E_1 \cup_{\Phi_t} E_2 \cong i_t^* (\pi^*(E_1) \cup_{\Psi} \pi^*(E_2)) . \quad (1)$$

{eq:kTheo-glu  
ingHomotopyIn  
variant}

The isomorphism can be seen by part (2) of Corollary 4.2.12. as follows: First notice the isomorphism  $\pi^*(E_i)|_{A \times \{t\}} \cong E_i$  for  $i = 1, 2$  and any  $t$ . By construction of the gluing this leads to the isomorphism

$$E_1 \cup_{\Phi_t} E_2 \cong \pi^*(E_1)|_{A \times \{t\}} \cup_{(\Phi_t, \text{id})} \pi^*(E_2)|_{A \times \{t\}} .$$

Now again by construction we notice, that gluing restricted spaces is the same as gluing the whole space and then restricting. Furthermore the map  $(\Phi_t, \text{id})$  is the restriction of  $\Psi$  to  $X \times \{t\}$ . Therefore:

$$\pi^*(E_1)|_{A \times \{t\}} \cup_{(\Phi_t, \text{id})} \pi^*(E_2)|_{A \times \{t\}} \cong (\pi^*(E_1) \cup_{\Psi} \pi^*(E_2))|_{X \times \{t\}}$$

Finally, pulling back via  $i_t$  is the same as restricting  $X \times i$  to  $X \times \{t\}$  and identifying  $X$  with  $X \times \{t\}$ . This concludes the chain of arguments:

$$(\pi^*(E_1) \cup_{\Psi} \pi^*(E_2))|_{X \times \{t\}} \cong i_t^* (\pi^*(E_1) \cup_{\Psi} \pi^*(E_2)) .$$

Since the pullback is homotopy invariant we can conclude by the isomorphism (1):

$$E_1 \cup_{\Phi_0} E_2 \cong E_1 \cup_{\Phi_1} E_2 .$$

□

def:kTheo-hom  
otopyClasses0  
fMaps

**Definition 4.2.14.** Let  $X, Y$  be topological spaces. By  $[X, Y]$  we denote the set of homotopy classes of maps from  $X$  to  $Y$ .

lem:kTheo-gluingAndHomotopyClassesToGLn

**Lemma 4.2.15.** *Let  $X = X_1 \cup X_2$  with  $X_1$  and  $X_2$  closed contractible spaces. Then there is a canonical bijection*

$$\text{Vect}_n(X) \rightarrow [A, \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})].$$

*Proof.* Let  $[E]$  be any vector bundle over  $X$  of rank  $n$ . Then  $E$  can be represented by a vector bundle obtained by gluing that is trivial on both  $X_i$ : Since  $X_i$  is contractible we can choose two trivializations

$$\alpha_1 : E|_{X_1} \rightarrow X_1 \times \mathbb{C}^n, \quad \text{and} \quad \alpha_2 : E|_{X_2} \rightarrow X_2 \times \mathbb{C}^n.$$

With part (2) of Corollary 4.2.12 we can conclude:

$$E \cong E|_{X_1} \cup_{\text{id}_A} E|_{X_2} \cong X \times \mathbb{C}^n \cup_{\alpha_2 \circ \alpha_1^{-1}|_A} X \times \mathbb{C}^n$$

Since a map between the two trivial bundles  $A \times \mathbb{C}^n \rightarrow A \times \mathbb{C}^n$  can be identified with a map  $A \rightarrow \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  we get an assignment from bundles over  $X$  together with the trivializations to maps  $A \rightarrow \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ . The next step is to show that two isomorphic vector bundles give homotopic maps: Assume that we are given two vector bundles  $E, F$  over  $X$  that are isomorphic via  $T : E \rightarrow F$  and without loss of generality we assume that they are given as the gluing of two trivial bundles:

$$E : X_1 \times \mathbb{C}^n \cup_{\varphi} X_2 \times \mathbb{C}^n, \quad \text{and} \quad F : X_1 \times \mathbb{C}^n \cup_{\psi} X_2 \times \mathbb{C}^n.$$

We now want to define a homotopy between  $\psi$  and  $\varphi$ . For this we start by splitting the isomorphism  $T$  into its two parts over  $X_1$  and  $X_2$ :

$$T|_{X_i} : X_i \times \mathbb{C}^n \rightarrow X_i \times \mathbb{C}^n.$$

These maps are given by maps

$$T_i : X_i \rightarrow \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}),$$

where the gluing compatibility of the  $T|_{X_i}$  yield for any  $a \in A$ :

$$\psi(a)T_1(a) = T_2(a)\varphi(a), \quad \text{equivalently} \quad \psi(a) = T_2(a)\varphi(a)T_1^{-1}(a).$$

By the contractibility of  $X_i$  we have for any fixed  $x_i \in X_i$  a homotopy  $h_t^i : X_i \rightarrow X_i$  such that  $h_0^i = c_{x_i}$  is the collapsing map whilst  $h_1^i = \text{id}_{X_i}$ . Furthermore, since  $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  is connected we have a path  $\gamma^i : I \rightarrow \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  that connects  $T_i(x_i) = \gamma^i(1)$  to  $\mathbb{1}_n = \gamma^i(0)$ . With this we can define the homotopies

$$T_{i,t} : X_i \rightarrow \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$$

$$x \mapsto \begin{cases} T_i \circ h_{2t}^i(x) & \text{if } t \leq \frac{1}{2}, \\ \gamma^i(2(t - \frac{1}{2})) & \text{if } t > \frac{1}{2}, \end{cases}$$

that satisfy  $T_{i,1} = T_i$  and  $T_{i,0}(x) = \mathbb{1}_n$  for all  $x$ . Finally we define the homotopy  $H_t : A \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  by

$$H_t(a) := T_{2,t}(a)\varphi(a)T_{1,t}^{-1}(a)$$

to get a homotopy from  $\varphi = H_0$  to  $\psi = H_1$ . Hence, we get a well defined map from isomorphism classes of bundles over  $X$  of rank  $n$  to the homotopy classes of maps from  $A$  to  $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  that is the inverse of the gluing construction and hence is bijective.  $\square$

ex:kTheo-taut  
opogicalLineB  
undleOverCP1

**Example 4.2.16.** We now want to analyze the tautological line bundle  $l$  over  $\mathbb{CP}^1$ . For this we cut  $\mathbb{CP}^1$  into the two pices whic are contractible as they come with homeomorphisms into the unit disc in  $\mathbb{C}$ :

$$\begin{aligned} H^+ &:= \{[x:y] \in \mathbb{CP}^1 \mid |x| \geq |y|\} \rightarrow D \subset \mathbb{C}, & [x:y] &\mapsto \frac{y}{x} \\ H^- &:= \{[x:y] \in \mathbb{CP}^1 \mid |x| \leq |y|\} \rightarrow D \subset \mathbb{C}, & [x:y] &\mapsto \frac{x}{y} \end{aligned}$$

Those maps give us unique representations of elements in  $H^+$  and  $H^-$ . We now want to evaluate the bijection  $\mathrm{Vect}_1(\mathbb{CP}^1) \rightarrow [H^+ \cap H^-, \mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C})]$  at  $[l]$ . The image of the intersection  $H^+ \cap H^-$  under the two maps is the bundary of the Disk and hence a circle. Furthermore,  $\mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C}) \cong \mathbb{C}^*$ . Hence, we know that the image is isomorphic tp  $[S^1, \mathbb{C}^*] \cong \pi(S^1) \cong \mathbb{Z}$ . This tells us, that there must be nontrivial vector bundles on  $\mathbb{CP}^1$ . By the proof of 4.2.15 we know that  $[l]$  gets mapped to the function gluing together trivializations over  $H^+$  and  $H^-$  along their intersection. To define the trivializations we need define local frames over  $H^+$  and  $H^-$ . Those frames are given by a single section defines as:

$$\begin{aligned} s_+ : H^+ &\rightarrow l, & [x:y] &\mapsto (1, \frac{y}{x}), \\ s_- : H^- &\rightarrow l, & [x:y] &\mapsto (\frac{x}{y}, 1). \end{aligned}$$

With those we define the trivializations:

$$\begin{aligned} t_+ : l|_{H^+} &\rightarrow H^+ \times \mathbb{C}, & ([x:y], \lambda \cdot s_+[x:y]) &\mapsto ([x:y], \lambda) \\ t_- : l|_{H^-} &\rightarrow H^- \times \mathbb{C}, & ([x:y], \mu \cdot s_-[x:y]) &\mapsto ([x:y], \mu) \end{aligned}$$

in each fiber over the intersection we have

$$\lambda \cdot s_+([x:y]) = \lambda(1, \frac{y}{x}) = \lambda \cdot \frac{y}{x}(\frac{x}{y}, 1) = \lambda \cdot \frac{y}{x}s_-([x:y])$$

Hence in each fibre over  $[x:y] \in H^+ \cap H^-$  the gluing function can be calculated:

$$\lambda \mapsto t_-|_{[x:y]} \circ t_+|_{[x:y]}^{-1}(\lambda) = t_-|_{[x:y]}(\lambda \cdot s_+([x:y])) = t_-|_{[x:y]}(\lambda \cdot \frac{y}{x} \cdot s_-([x:y])) = \lambda \cdot \frac{y}{x}$$

Hence, as a map from  $H^+ \cap H^- \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C}) \cong \mathbb{C}^*$  this map reads:

$$H^+ \cap H^- \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^* \quad [x:y] \mapsto \frac{y}{x}$$



viewing this as an element of  $\pi(S^1)$  by identifying the intersection with a circle via the homeomorphism from  $H^+ \rightarrow D \subseteq \mathbb{C}$  we notice that the gluing map corresponds to the identity in  $\pi(S^1)$ . If the bundle  $l$  would be trivial, the gluing function would be homotopically equivalent to the constant one-function  $H^+ \cap H^- \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^*$  that maps all  $[x : y] \mapsto 1$ . This cannot be, because interpreted as elements in  $\pi(S)$  they are different.

def:kTheo-met  
ricsOnBundles

**Definition 4.2.17** (Metrics on Bundles). A **metric** on a complex bundle  $E$  is a section  $h : X \rightarrow \text{Herm}(E)$  such that  $h(x)$  is positive definite for all  $x$ .  $\text{Herm}(E)$  denotes the bundle of hermitian forms (conjugate-symmetric sesquilinear) in each fiber. A bundle together with a metric is a **Hermitian bundle**.

def:kTheo-pro  
jectionOperat  
or

**Definition 4.2.18** (Projection Operator). A **projection operator**  $P : E \rightarrow E$  is a bundlehomomorphism in  $E$  such that  $P^2 = P$ .

lem:kTheo-pro  
jectionsGives  
umdecompositi  
on

**Lemma 4.2.19.** *Any projection operator  $P : E \rightarrow E$  determines a direct sum decomposition  $E = PE \oplus (1 - P)E$ .*

*Proof.* Observe that fibrewise  $1 - P$  maps each  $\xi$  to the kernel of  $P$ , and hence fiberwise  $P(E)$  and  $(1 - P)(E)$  are disjoint. Furthermore  $\text{im}(P) + \text{im}(1 - P) = E$ , because  $v = P(v) + (v - P(v))$ . Therefore in each fibre we have the direct sum  $E_x = P(E_x) \oplus (1 - P)(E_x)$ . Now the question is, if that gives a global splitting, meaning that  $P(E)$  and  $(1 - P)(E)$  are continuous as subbundles of  $E$ . For this to be true, we need local triviality, which is clear as long as the rank of  $P$  (and  $(1 - P)$ ) is locally constant. In each fiber we know that  $\text{rank}(P_x) + \text{rank}(1 - P) = \dim(E_x)$ . Furthermore,  $\text{rank}(P_x)$  and  $\text{rank}(1 - P)$  are locally constant. To see this first notice that they are lower semi continuous, meaning that for  $y$  from a small enough neighbourhood of  $x$   $\text{rank}(P_x) \leq \text{rank}(P_y)$ . To see this, pick a  $\text{rank}(P_x)_x \times \text{rank}(P_x)_x$  minor with nonzero determinant. The latter is an open condition and hence stable under small perturbation. But now we have the sum of two lower semi continuous functions that give something locally constant and hence, each summand is locally constant. Finally the above shows that  $\ker(P) = (1 - P)(E)$  we have the decomposition.  $\square$

lem:kTheo-met  
ricInducedCom  
plement

**Lemma 4.2.20** (Metric Induced Complement). *Suppose that  $F$  is a sub-bundle of  $E$ . Then a metric provides a canonical complementary sub-bundle.*

*Proof.* Let  $h$  denote the metric. For each  $x$  we have the orthonormal projection  $P_x : E_x \rightarrow F_x$  inducing a map  $P : E \rightarrow F$ . Let  $(f_1, \dots, f_n)$  be an orthonormal frame of  $F$ . Then fiberwise with  $\xi \in E_x$  the orthogonal projection is given by

$$P_x(\xi) = \sum_i h_x(\xi, f_i(x)) f_i(x).$$

And since  $h$  is continuous the whole map  $P$  is. Furthermore  $P^2 = P$  and hence we get a canonical sum decomposition.  $\square$

**Definition 4.2.21.** We call a sequence of bundle homomorphisms

$$\cdots \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow \cdots$$

exact, if it is fiberwise exact.

lem:kTheo-spl  
ittingPrinzip  
le

**Lemma 4.2.22** (Splitting Prinzip). *Every short exact sequence of bundles over the same base space splits.*

*Proof.* Let  $X$  be the base space and assume that the sequence is given as

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \xrightarrow{\varphi'} E \xrightarrow{\varphi''} E'' \longrightarrow 0$$

Now it is well known that any short exact sequence of vector spaces splits. We just need to ensure that this splitting is continuous. For this we give  $E$  a metric. Now since  $\varphi'$  is injective,  $\varphi'(E')$  is a subbundle. By Lemma 4.2.20 we can split  $E \cong \varphi'(E') \oplus L$ . However,  $\varphi''|_L$  is fiberwise (and hence as a bundle map) an isomorphism. This can be seen as  $\varphi''$  being surjective and trivial on  $\varphi'(E')$  hence the restriction is still surjective. The injectivity is also clear as the kernel by the homomorphism theorem of linear maps. But then we clearly have  $E = E' \oplus E''$  and the sequence is isomorphic as a short exact sequence to the splitting one:

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \xrightarrow{i_1} E' \oplus E'' \xrightarrow{\pi_2} E'' \longrightarrow 0$$

□

def:kTheo-amp  
leSubspace

**Definition 4.2.23.** A subspace  $V \subseteq \Gamma(E)$ , where  $\Gamma(E)$  is viewed as a  $\mathbb{C}$ -vector space is called **ample**, if

$$\varphi : X \times V \rightarrow E, \quad \varphi(x, s) := s(x)$$

is a surjection.

**Corollary 4.2.24.** If the subspace  $V$  is ample and  $\dim(V) = \text{rank}(E)$ , then  $E$  is trivializable.

lem:kTheo-amp  
leSubspaceExi  
sts

**Lemma 4.2.25.** *For any vector bundle  $E$  over a compact space  $X$ , there exists an finite dimensional ample subspace of  $\Gamma(E)$ .*

*Proof.* Let  $\{U_\alpha\}$  be a finite open cover of  $X$  such that  $E|_{U_\alpha}$  is trivial. Let  $\{s_{\alpha,i}\}$  be the corresponding local frames, and define  $V_\alpha$  to be the finite dimensional ample subspace  $V_\alpha \subseteq \Gamma(E|_{U_\alpha})$ . Let  $\rho_\alpha$  be a partition of unity subordinate to the cover  $\{U_\alpha\}$ . Define

$$\theta_\alpha : V_\alpha \rightarrow \Gamma(E), \quad \theta_\alpha(s_\alpha)(x) = \begin{cases} s_\alpha(x) \cdot \rho_\alpha(x) & \text{if } x \in U_\alpha, \\ 0 & \text{else.} \end{cases}$$

Then the  $\theta_\alpha$  give rise to a homomorphism

$$\theta : \Pi_\alpha V_\alpha \rightarrow \Gamma(E),$$

and the image of  $\theta$  is finite dimensional and ample. The surjectivity is clear, as for any  $x$  there exists a  $\rho_\alpha(x) > 0$  making the map

$$\theta_\alpha(V_\alpha) \rightarrow E_x$$

a surjection.  $\square$

cor:kTheo-epi  
FromTrivial

**Corollary 4.2.26.** If  $E$  is any bundle over  $X$ , there exists an epimorphism  $\varphi : X \times \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow E$  for some integer  $m$ .

*Proof.* Just take a basis  $(s_1, \dots, s_m)$  of an ample subspace  $V$  and define  $\varphi(x, e_i) = s_i(x)$ , where  $e_i$  is the  $i$ -th standard basis vector of  $\mathbb{C}^m$ .  $\square$

cor:kTheo-spl  
ittingTrivial

**Corollary 4.2.27.** If  $E$  is a bundle over  $X$ , there exists a bundle  $F$  such that  $E \oplus F$  is trivial.

*Proof.* By Corollary 4.2.26 there exists an epimorphism  $\varphi : X \times \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow E$ . The kernel of  $\varphi$  is a subbundle of  $X \times \mathbb{C}^m$  and hence by Lemma 4.2.22 we have a splitting of the short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker(\varphi) \longrightarrow X \times \mathbb{C}^m \xrightarrow{\varphi} E \longrightarrow 0$$

Hence, the middle term becomes isomorphic to the direct sum of the outer terms and we get  $X \times \mathbb{C}^m \cong E \oplus \ker(\varphi)$ .  $\square$

def:kTheo-gra  
ssmanManifold

**Definition 4.2.28** (Grassmann Manifold). Let  $V$  be a vector space and  $n$  be any integer. The **Grassmann manifold**  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  is the set of all subspaces of  $V$  with **codimension**  $n$ . If  $V$  is given a Hermitian metric, we can topologize  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  as a subspace of the set of all projection operators on  $V$  and this defines a map

$$P : \text{Gr}_n(V) \rightarrow \text{End}(V),$$

where  $\text{End}(V)$  is the space of all endomorphisms of  $V$  with the operator norm topology. We give  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  the subspace topology of  $\text{End}(V)$ .

def:kTheo-cla  
ssifyingMap

**Definition 4.2.29.** Suppose that  $E$  is a bundle over  $X$ ,  $V$  is a vector space and  $\varphi : X \times V \rightarrow E$  is an epimorphism. Then we can define a map  $f : X \rightarrow \text{Gr}_{\dim(V)}(V)$  by sending  $x$  to the kernel of  $\varphi_x : V \rightarrow E_x$ . We call  $f$  to be **induced by**  $\varphi$ . This map is continuous for any metric on  $V$ . To see this notice that the topology on  $V$  is metric invariant, as  $V$  is finite dimensional. Now the map  $f$  is continuous if the map for the map

$$P : \text{Gr}_n(V) \rightarrow \text{End}(V)$$

the composition  $P \circ f$  is continuous. But  $P \circ f$  is given by sending  $x$  to the projection onto  $\ker(\varphi_x)$ , which is continuous as  $\varphi$  is.

def:kTheo-cla  
ssifyingBundl  
e

**Definition 4.2.30** (Classifying Bundle). Let  $V$  be a vector space and  $F \subseteq \text{Gr}_n(V) \times V$  be the subbundle consisting of all points  $(g, v)$  such that  $v \in g$ . We call  $F$  the **tautological bundle** over  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$ . Furthermore, if  $E = (\text{Gr}_n(V) \times V)/F$  is the quotient bundle, we call  $E$  the **classifying bundle** over  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$ .

**Corollary 4.2.31.** If  $E'$  is a bundle over  $X$ , and  $\varphi : X \times V \rightarrow E'$  is an epimorphism, then  $\varphi$  induces a map  $f : X \rightarrow \text{Gr}_m(V)$  such that  $E' \cong f^*E$ , where  $E$  is the classifying bundle over  $\text{Gr}_m(V)$ . The isomorphism follows from a fiberwise construction because  $E_x \cong V / \ker(\varphi_x)$ . The latter however is exactly the fiber over  $\ker(x)$  in the classifying bundle and hence the pullback via the  $\varphi$  induced map gives an isomorphism. That motivates the name "classifying bundle" for  $E$  and "classifying map" for  $f$ .

lem:kTheo-Gra  
ssmanTopology  
MetricInvaria  
nt

**Lemma 4.2.32.** *The topology on  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  is independent of the choice of the metric on  $V$ .*

*Proof.* Let  $h$  and  $h'$  be two metrics on  $V$ . Then we denote the topological space  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  with the topology induced by  $h$  by  $\text{Gr}(V_h)$  and the one induced by  $h'$  by  $\text{Gr}(V_{h'})$ . We need to show that the identity map  $\text{id} : \text{Gr}(V_h) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(V_{h'})$  is a homeomorphism. For this we need to show that  $\text{id}$  is continuous. The projection  $\text{Gr}_n(V_h) \times V_{h'} \rightarrow E$  (where  $E$  is the classifying bundle) is an epimorphism and hence induces a classifying map  $f : \text{Gr}_n(V_h) \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(V_{h'})$  such that  $f^*E \cong E$ . However that map is given by the identity on  $\text{Gr}_n(V)$  and hence the identity is continuous by Definition 4.2.29.  $\square$

**Remark 4.2.33.** To continue further we need direct limits of directed systems to construct general grassmanians. However we will also need said construction for topological spaces and groups. Hence, we will give the definitions for arbitrary categories.

**Definition 4.2.34** (Directed System). Let  $\mathcal{C}$  be a categorie and  $(I, \leq)$  be a partial ordered set where every finite subset is bounded from above. Let  $(A_i)_{i \in I}$  be a family of objects from  $\mathcal{C}$  and  $f_{ij} : A_i \rightarrow A_j$  be a morphism for all  $i \leq j$  that satisfies:

1.  $f_{ii} = \text{id}_{A_i}$  for all  $i \in I$ .
2.  $f_{kj} \circ f_{ik} = f_{ij}$  for all  $i \leq k \leq j$ .

The pair  $((A_i)_{i \in I}, (f_{ij})_{i \leq j})$  is called a **direct system**.

**Definition 4.2.35** (Direkt Limit). Let  $((A_i)_{i \in I}, (f_{ij})_{i \leq j})$  be a direct system in a categorie  $\mathcal{C}$ . A pair  $(X, (\varphi_i)_{i \in I})$  where  $X$  is an object of  $\mathcal{C}$  and  $\varphi_i : A_i \rightarrow X$  are morphisms such that  $\varphi_j \circ f_{ij} = \varphi_i$  for all  $i \leq j$  is called a direct limit, if the following universal property holds: For any family of morphisms  $g_i : A_i \rightarrow Y$  that satisfies  $g_i \circ f_{ji} = g_j$  for all  $i \leq j$  there exists a unique morphism  $g : X \rightarrow Y$  such that  $g_i = g \circ \varphi_i$ . We denote the space  $X$  by  $\text{colim}_i A_i$  (or just  $\text{colim } A_i$ ), where the maps  $f_{ij}$  are omitted from the notation.

**Corollary 4.2.36.** As always, the direct Limit is (if it exists) unique up to unique isomorphism.

**Remark 4.2.37** (Construction of Direct Limits). We will now see three constructions of direct limits. Let  $((A_i)_{i \in I}, (f_{ij})_{i \leq j})$  denote a directed system in the noted categorie.

*In the categorie of sets* we define the direct limit by

$$\operatorname{colim}_i A_i := \bigsqcup A_i / \sim,$$

where  $x \sim y$  if there exists  $i, j, k \in I$  such that  $f_{ik}(x) = f_{jk}(y)$ . This gives an equivalence relation. The maps  $\varphi_i : A_i \rightarrow \operatorname{colim}_i A_i$  are the composition of the inclusion into the disjoint union with the projection onto the quotient space. The universal property is easy to verify. For a family of suitable maps  $g_i : A_i \rightarrow B$  we define the map  $g : \operatorname{colim}_i A_i \rightarrow B$  as  $g(x) = g_m(x)$  for  $x \in A_m$ . This is welldefined since the  $g_i$  are compatible with the  $f_{ij}$  and unique by definition.

*In the categorie of topological spaces* we define the direct limit to be the settheoretic direct limit equipped with the final topology of the inclusions, i.e. a subset  $U \subseteq \operatorname{colim}_i A_i$  is open if and only if  $\varphi_i^{-1}(U)$  is open for all  $i$ . Again the universal property is easy to prove by using the construction of the universal map from the settheoretic limit. To show the continuity we show that  $g^{-1}(U)$  is open for any open  $U$  which is checked by verifying openness of  $\varphi_i^{-1}(g^{-1}(U))$  for all  $i$ , which in turn equals  $g_i^{-1}(U)$  and is open as the  $g_i$  are continuous. Uniqueness follows from the uniqueness of  $g$  established already in set.

*In an algebraic categorie like semigroups, groups, rings* we define the direct limit again as the settheoretic direct limit, where the algebraic operations are defined such that the  $\varphi_i$  are homomorphisms meaning for example (if  $+$  is an operation in the  $A_i$ )  $a \in A_i$  and  $b \in A_j$  we define  $a + b$  in  $\operatorname{colim}_i A_i$  by including the sum  $f_{ik}(a) + f_{jk}(b)$  which is defined in  $A_k$ . Again the universal morphism  $g$  is the one from the settheoretic limit which now is a homomorphism by construction.

rem:kTheo-sta  
ircaseMapsClo  
sedEmbedding

**Remark 4.2.38.** If we build the direct limit of sets and all the maps of the direct system are injective, then the inclusions into the direct limit are injective. If all the maps of the direct system are closed embeddings, then the inclusions into the direct are also closed embeddings.

*Proof.* Recall that the inclusions  $\varphi_i : A_i \rightarrow \operatorname{colim}_i A_i$  are defined to be the composition of the inclusion into the disjoint union with the projection onto the quotient. Now assume that all maps  $f_{ij}$  in the direct system are injective and  $\varphi_i(x) = \varphi_i(y)$ . Then  $x \sim y$  in the quotient and hence, there exists  $i, j, k \in I$  such that  $f_{ik}(x) = f_{jk}(y)$  which implies that  $x = y$ .

Now assume that all  $f_{ij}$  are closed embeddings. Then, the inclusions are injective by the settheoretic argument. Furthermore, the images of  $\varphi_i : A_i \rightarrow \operatorname{colim}_i A_i$  are closed. That follows from subsets in the final topology being closed, if and only if all their

preimages are closed. Hence we check if  $\varphi_j(\varphi(A_i))$  is closed for all  $j \in I$ :

$$\begin{aligned} \text{If } j \leq i \text{ then: } & \varphi_j^{-1}(\varphi_i(A_i)) = (\varphi_i \circ f_{ji})^{-1}(\varphi_i(A_i)) = f_{ji}^{-1}(A_i) \text{ which is closed.} \\ \text{If } i < j \text{ then: } & \varphi_j^{-1}(\varphi_i(A_i)) = \underbrace{\varphi_j^{-1}(\varphi_j \circ f_{ij}(A_i))}_{\varphi \text{ is injective}} = f_{ij}(A_i) \text{ which is closed.} \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

{eq:kTheo-sta  
ircaseMapsClo  
sedEmbedding}

To show that  $\varphi_i^{-1} : \text{im}(\varphi_i) \rightarrow A_i$  is continuous we assume that  $B \subset A_i$  is open. then  $\varphi_i(B)$  is open if and only if for any  $j$   $\varphi_j^{-1}(\varphi_i(B))$  is open. This follows from the same calculations as in equation (2) using that the  $f_{ij}$  are homeomorphisms onto their image.  $\square$

cor:kTheo-dir  
ectGrassmanSy  
stem

**Corollary 4.2.39.** The so-called inverse system given by the projections

$$\pi : \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{m-1}, \quad (x_1, \dots, x_m) \mapsto (x_1, \dots, x_{m-1}),$$

induces an direct system of Grassmann manifolds with the induced continuous maps

$$i_{m-1} : \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m-1}) \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m), \quad U \mapsto \pi^{-1}(U).$$

If we denote the classifying bundle over  $\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)$  by  $E_m$ , then the pullback of  $E_m$  along  $i_{m-1}$  is isomorphic to  $E_{m-1}$ .

thm:kTheory-c  
lassifyingSpa  
ce

**Theorem 4.2.40.** The map

$$\text{colim}_m[X, \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)] \rightarrow \text{Vect}_n(X),$$

induced by  $f \mapsto f^* E_m$  is a bijection for all compact spaces  $X$ .

*Proof.* We shall construct an inverse map. If  $E$  is a bundle over  $X$ , then by Corollary 4.2.26 there exists an epimorphism  $\varphi : X \times \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow E$  for some integer  $m$ . Let  $f : X \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)$  be the map induced by  $\varphi$ . If we manage to show that the homotopy class of  $f$  as a map to  $\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m'})$  for some large enough  $m'$  is independent of the choice of  $\varphi$  and  $m$ , then we get a well defined map from  $\text{Vect}_n(X)$  to  $\text{colim}_m[X, \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)]$  that is inverse to the classifying map.

Suppose that  $\varphi_i : X \times \mathbb{C}^{m_i} \rightarrow E$  for  $i = 1, 2$  are two epimorphisms. Let  $g_i : X \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_i})$  be the maps induced by  $\varphi_i$ . We want to show that  $g_1$  and  $g_2$  are homotopic as maps to  $\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2})$ . For this we define the map

$$\psi_t : X \times \mathbb{C}^{m_1} \times \mathbb{C}^{m_2} \rightarrow E, \quad \psi_t(x, v_1, v_2) = t\varphi_1(x, v_1) + (1-t)\varphi_2(x, v_2).$$

Since the  $\varphi_i$  are epimorphisms, this map is an epimorphism for any  $t$ . Let

$$f_t : X \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2})$$

be the maps induced by  $\psi_t$ . (where we identified  $\mathbb{C}^{m_1} \times \mathbb{C}^{m_2}$  with  $\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2}$  by mapping  $(v_1, v_2)$  to  $(v_1, v_2)$ ). Then

$$f_0 = j_0 \circ g_1 \quad \text{and} \quad f_1 = T \circ j_1 \circ g_2,$$

where  $j_i : \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_i}) \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2})$  is the map induced by the inclusion  $\mathbb{C}^{m_i} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2}$  and  $T$  is the map induced by the isomorphism  $\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2}$  that sends  $(v_1, v_2)$  to  $(v_2, v_1)$ . Since  $T$  is homotopic to the identity, we can conclude that  $j_0 \circ g_1$  and  $j_1 \circ g_2$  are homotopic as maps to  $\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m_1+m_2})$ . Hence, the homotopy class of the map induced by an epimorphism is independent of the choice of the epimorphism and the integer  $m$ . This concludes the proof.  $\square$

lem:kTheo-col  
imUndHomVerta  
uschen

**Lemma 4.2.41.** *For any compact  $X$  and direct system  $((Y_m)_{m \in \mathbb{N}}, (i_m)_{m \in \mathbb{N}})$  where all  $Y_m$  are Hausdorff and all  $i_m$  are closed embeddings we have a canonical bijection between the set theoretic direct limit of homotopy classes of maps and the homotopy classes of maps to the topological direct limit:*

$$\text{colim}_m [X, X_m] \cong [X, \text{colim}_m X_m].$$

*Proof.* We denote  $\text{colim}_m Y_m = Y$  and the corresponding inclusion  $\varphi_m : Y_m \rightarrow Y$ . Since  $X$  is compact, any map  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  has image that is in some  $\text{im}(\varphi_m)$  for  $m$  big enough. Assume that this was not the case, then would exist an increasing series  $(j_i)_{i \in \mathbb{N}}$  such that for all  $i$  there is an  $x_i$  with  $f(x_i) \in \text{im} \varphi_{j_i} \setminus \text{im} \varphi_{j_i-1}$ . With this we define the set

$$A := \{f(x_i) \mid i \in \mathbb{N}\} \subseteq \text{im} f \subseteq Y.$$

Then  $A$  is closed, since for all  $m$  the intersection  $\text{im} \varphi_m \cap A$  is finite and since  $\text{im}(\varphi_m)$  is closed, said intersection is closed. By the final topology we can conclude that the whole  $A$  is closed and since it is contained in the image of  $f$  it is compact (Here we use that the  $Y_i$  are Hausdorff!). Furthermore, the same argument shows that every subset  $B \subset A$  is closed, because again  $B \cap \text{im} \varphi_m$  is finite. This tells us that  $A$  as a subset of  $Y$  carries the discrete topology: Let  $C \subseteq A$  be an arbitrary subset. Then  $A \setminus C \subseteq A$  is closed in  $Y$  and hence its complement in  $Y$  is an open and intersected with  $A$  yields  $C$ . Hence,  $C$  is open in the subspace topology. This however is a contradiction, as  $A$  cannot be infinite, compact and carry the discrete topology. Hence any map  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  has image that is in some  $\text{im}(\varphi_m)$  for  $m$  big enough. But then there exists a  $f_m$  such that  $f = \varphi_m \circ f_m$ . This assignment is well defined on homotopy classes because if  $f, s : X \rightarrow Y$  are homotopic, then there exists a homotopy  $H : X \times I \rightarrow Y$  between them: By the same argument as before, the image of  $H$  is compact and hence contained in some  $\text{im} \varphi_m$ . Hence,  $f_m$  and  $s_m$  are homotopic via  $H_m$  as maps to  $\text{im} \varphi_m$ . Hence, we get a well defined canonical map

$$\Phi : [X, \text{colim}_m Y_m] \rightarrow \text{colim}_m [X, Y_m].$$

This map is injective, as if  $f_m$  and  $s_m$  are homotopic as maps to  $\text{im} \varphi_m$ , then they are also homotopic as maps to the direct limit. Finally  $\Phi$  is surjective, as any element of the direct limit is represented by some  $f_m : X \rightarrow Y_m$  and hence  $\Phi([f_m]) = [f_m]$ .  $\square$

**Definition 4.2.42.** We denote  $\operatorname{colim}_m \operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)$  by  $\operatorname{BU}(n)$  and call it the **classifying space** for complex vector bundles of rank  $n$ . The name origins from the functor  $B$  that sends a topological group  $G$  to the classifying space of vector bundles with structure group  $G$ .

cor:kTheo-classifyingSpace  
VectorBundles

**Corollary 4.2.43.** For any compact space  $X$ , there is a canonical bijection between the homotopy classes of maps from  $X$  to  $\operatorname{BU}(n)$  and the isomorphism classes of vector bundles of rank  $n$  over  $X$ :

$$[X, \operatorname{BU}(n)] \cong \operatorname{Vect}_n(X).$$

*Proof.* This is a direct application of Lemma 4.2.41.  $\square$

### 4.3 K-Theory as a Cohomology Theory

**Definition 4.3.1.** We need the following categories of topological spaces:

- **CWH** is the category of compact spaces.
- $\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  is the category of well-pointed compact spaces.
- $\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2$  is the category of pairs of compact spaces, where the inclusions are cofibrations.

Here, we have the natural functors:

- $\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2 \rightarrow \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  by sending a pair  $(X, Y) \mapsto (X/Y, [Y])$  with obvious morphisms. If  $Y = \emptyset$  this is the disjoint union of  $X$  with a point.
- $\mathbf{CWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2$  by sending  $X \mapsto (X, \emptyset)$  again with obvious morphisms. the inclusion of  $\emptyset$  into  $X$  is a cofibration, as the empty set itself is a open neighbourhood and hence the pair is a NDR pair.
- $\mathbf{CWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  as the composition. Again, the inclusion of  $[\emptyset]$  into the disjoint union  $X \sqcup [\emptyset]$  is a cofibration, as  $\{[\emptyset]\}$  is an open neighbourhood of itself.

If we decent to the category where the morphisms are homotopy classes of maps, we get the categories  $\mathbf{hCWH}$ ,  $\mathbf{hCWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  and  $\mathbf{hCWH}_{\text{cof}}^2$ . Furthermore, the construction gives a functor from the categorie of abelian semigroups to the categorie of abelian groups.

def:kTheo-grothendiekGroup  
AndRing

**Definition 4.3.2** (Grothendiek Group and Ring). Let  $A$  be an abelian semigroup. Then the **Grothendiek group** of  $A$  is the abelian group  $K(A)$  together with a homomorphism  $\varphi : A \rightarrow K(A)$  such that for any other group  $G$  together with a homomorphism  $\psi : A \rightarrow G$ , there exists a unique homomorphism  $\tilde{\psi} : K(A) \rightarrow G$  such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & K(A) \\ & \searrow \psi & \downarrow \tilde{\psi} \\ & & G \end{array}$$



If  $G$  is a semiring, then  $K(G)$  inherits a ring structure and we call  $K(G)$  the **Grothendieck ring** of  $G$ .

cor:kTheo-Con  
structionOfGro  
othendiekGrou  
p

**Corollary 4.3.3.** The Grothendieck group exists for any abelian semigroup and is unique up to canonical isomorphism. If  $G$  is a semiring, then the Grothendieck ring exists and is unique up to canonical isomorphism.

*Proof.* The construction follows the following idea: We define touples in which  $(a, b)$  that are to be interpreted as differences " $a-b$ ". For this constructino to yeald something useful we want to enforce the rule that " $a-b = a+c-(b+c)$ " or said differently  $(a+c, b+c) = (a, b)$ . Finally, to accfount for the universal property, we want to use the smallest relation that obeys siad rule. This gives us the following construction: Let  $A$  be an abelian semigroup and  $\Delta : A \rightarrow A \times A$  be the diaglinal homomorphism that sends  $a$  to  $(a, a)$ . Let  $K(A) := A \times A / \Delta(A)$ . By this notation we mean:  $\Delta(A)$  acts on  $A \times A$  via

$$\Delta(A) \times (A \times A) \rightarrow A \times A \quad ((a, a), (b, c)) \mapsto (a + b, a + c).$$

With this we have the set of orbits which gives rise to an relation:

$$\mathcal{R} := \{((a, b), (a + c, b + c)) | c \in A\}$$

Now we take the smallest equivalence relation on  $A \times A$  that contains  $\mathcal{R}$  (This relation is made explicit in Remark 4.3.4). We define  $K(A)$  to be  $A \times A$  module said relation. Then  $K(A)$  is a priori an abelian semigroup, but for  $a, b \in A$  we have

$$(a, b) + (b, a) = (a + b, b + a) \in \Delta(A),$$

and hence  $K(A)$  is an abelian group. Also we can see that

$$\overline{(a, b)} = \overline{(a, 0)} - \overline{(b, 0)} = \alpha_A(a) - \alpha_A(b)$$

Together with the homomorphism  $\alpha_A : A \rightarrow K(A)$  that sends  $a$  to the class of  $(a, 0)$ , we get the universal property of the Grothendieck group:

Let  $G$  be another abelian group and  $\psi : A \rightarrow G$  a semigroup homomorphism. From this define

$$\tilde{\psi} : K(A) \rightarrow G, \quad \overline{(a, b)} \mapsto \psi(a) - \psi(b)$$

The well definition of this map can be verified by a calculation. By calculating it also follows that  $\tilde{\psi}$  is a group homomorphism and that  $\tilde{\psi} \circ \alpha_A = \psi$ . Hence, for the universal property we only need to verify uniqueness. So assume that  $\theta : K(A) \rightarrow G$  is another group homomorphism. Then:

$$\theta(\overline{(a, b)}) = \underbrace{\theta(\alpha_A(a))}_{\psi(a)} - \underbrace{\theta(\alpha_A(b))}_{\psi(b)} = \tilde{\psi}(\overline{(a, b)})$$

This concludes the construction of the grothendiek group. To see the functoriality we first need to define what  $K(\beta)$  means, when  $\beta : A \rightarrow B$  defines a semigrroub homomorphism

between to abelian semigroups. For this we use the universal property and define  $K(\beta)$  to be the unique group homomorphism coming from  $\alpha_B \circ \beta : A \rightarrow K(B)$ . Now the uniqueness of said definition shows the equalities  $K(\text{id}) = \text{id}$  and  $K(f \circ g) = K(f) \circ K(g)$ .  $\square$

rem:kTheo-gro  
thendieckEquiv  
alence

**Remark 4.3.4.** In  $K(A)$  we get the following equivalence for any two pairs  $\overline{(a, b)}$  and  $\overline{(a', b')}$ :

$$\overline{(a, b)} = \overline{(a', b')} \Leftrightarrow \text{There exists a } c \in A \text{ such that } (a + b' + c) = (a' + b + c).$$

*Proof.* We start by proving " $\Leftarrow$ ". This direction follows from the properties of an equivalence relation, as then, every element of an equivalence class is also a representant:

$$\overline{(a, b)} = \overline{(a + (a' + b + c), b + (a + b' + c))} = \overline{(a' + (a + b + c), b' + (a + b + c))} = \overline{(a', b')}. \quad (3)$$

{eq:kTheo-the  
GrothendieckRe  
lation}

The other direction follows from the minimality of the equivalence relation: To see this notice how the argument above works in every equivalence relation containing the orbits of  $\Delta(A)$  and hence works in the smallest one. Furthermore,

$$(a, b) \sim (a', b') \Leftrightarrow \text{There exists a } c \in A \text{ such that } (a + b' + c) = (a' + b + c)$$

defines an equivalence relation that contains the orbits and hence this is the smallest one.  $\square$

**Remark 4.3.5** (A simpler Construction of the Grothendieck Group?). One might be wondering, why we defined the relation on the pair  $A \times A$  as the smallest equivalence relation starting identifying the orbits of the operation of the diagonal, when Remark 4.3.4 might look and feel different. The reason for this detour is that I wanted to understand what Atiyah meant when he defined in Chapter II.1 [Ati89] word for word:

Atiyah1989k

*A slightly different construction of  $K(A)$  which is sometimes convenient is the following: Let  $\Delta : A \rightarrow A$  be the diagonal homomorphism of semi-groups, and let  $K(A)$  denote the set of cosets of  $\Delta(A)$  in  $A \times A$ . It is a quotient semi-group, but the interchange of factors in  $A \times A$  introduces an inverse in  $K(A)$  so that  $K(A)$  is a group.*

Whilst this definition feels easy to the reader, it carries a lot of baggage. First of all, if one is not familiar with commutative monoid or abelian semigroup theory, one might want to generalize the notion of coset from group theory that states that for a subgroup  $A \subseteq G$  of an abelian group  $G$  the cosets are of the form  $g + A$ . Whilst this notion can be generalized to semigroups, it would yield something useless. To see this just take  $\mathbb{N}$ . In the semigroup  $\mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N} / \Delta(\mathbb{N})$  the cosets  $(2, 0) + \mathbb{N}$  and  $(3, 1) + \mathbb{N}$  are different, as  $(2, 0)$  is not contained in the latter. To give Atiyah the benefit of the doubt we could generalize the definition of cosets as orbits of the right translation, which is what we did in our construction. However, the literature on semigroups from that time defines the notion of quotients in the setting of semigroups with the help of *congruence* instead of cosets. The latter refers to an equivalence relation that behaves well with the operation of said semigroup. Compare Chapter 1.5 [CP61]. It was even shown that the notion of congruence and coset are equivalent for groups (Compare for

CliffordPreston1961

example: Chapter 6.1 [Green1965]. Regardless of what Atiyah meant by his notion of coset, the construction became known and cited. ([Bro96], [Lan05], [Cou04]) None of those reference defined coset in semigroups and hence this little detour into the history should function as a reminder, that we need to be careful when generalizing things from the known categories. We are so used to cosets giving equivalence relations, that its easy to overlook the needed care.

**Remark 4.3.6.** We will omitt the incluion maps  $\alpha$  from now on and interpret (if not said different) the equivalence class  $[E]$  of a vector bundle as an element in  $K(X)$ .

**Corollary 4.3.7.** In the proof above we have shown that the assignement  $K$  is a functor from the category of abelian semigroups to the category of abelian groups. Alternatively, we can view  $K$  as a functor from the category of semirings to the category of rings.

**Definition 4.3.8.** Let  $X$  be a compact Hausdorff space. We define the **K-group** of  $X$  to be the Grothendiek ring of the semiring  $\text{Vect}(X)$  of isomorphism classes of vector bundles over  $X$  with the direct sum as addition and the tensor product as multiplication. We denote the K-group of  $X$  by  $K(X)$ . As a whole we get a contravariant functor from the category of compact Hausdorff spaces to the category of rings

$$\mathbf{CWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{Ring} . \quad (4)$$

**Remark 4.3.9.** For a continuous map  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  we denote the induced map  $K(f^*) : K(Y) \rightarrow K(X)$  by just  $f^*$ .

**Theorem 4.3.10.** *The functor  $K : \mathbf{CWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{Ring}$  factors over the homotopy category  $\mathbf{hCWH}$  of compact Hausdorff spaces together with homotopy classes of maps.*

*Proof.* This directly follows from Theorem 4.2.4. □

def:kTheo-reducedKTheory

**Definition 4.3.11** (Reduced K-Theory). Let  $X$  be a compact Hausdorff space and  $x_0 \in X$  be a base point. We define the **reduced K-group**  $\tilde{K}(X)$  of  $X$  to be the kernel of the map  $K(X) \rightarrow K(\{x_0\})$  induced by the inclusion  $\{x_0\} \rightarrow X$ .

cor:kTheo-splittingReducedGroupNatural

**Corollary 4.3.12.** If  $c : X \rightarrow x_0$  is the collapsing map sending each point to the base-point, then we get a natural splitting

$$K(X) \cong \tilde{K}(X) \oplus K(x_0) .$$

Naturality here means, that for any homomorphism of pointes spaces  $f : (X, x_0) \rightarrow (Y, y_0)$  we have a commuting diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K(X) & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(X) \oplus K(x_0) \\ \downarrow f^* & & \downarrow \tilde{K}(f) \oplus (\{x_0\} \rightarrow \{y_0\})^* \\ K(Y) & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(Y) \oplus K(y_0) \end{array}$$

*Proof.* We have the exact sequence of Rings:

$$0 \longrightarrow \tilde{K}(X) \xrightarrow{\text{inclusion}} K(X) \xrightarrow{i_X^*} K(x_0) \longrightarrow 0$$

where  $c_X^*: K(x_0) \rightarrow K(X)$  is a right inverse of  $i_X^*$ , and hence the sequence splits and  $K(X) \cong \tilde{K}(X) \oplus K(x_0)$ . The isomorphism is explicitly given by

$$K(X) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(X) \oplus K(x_0), \quad \xi \mapsto (\xi - c_X^* \circ i_X^*(\xi), i_X^*(\xi))$$

and its inverse maps  $(a, b) \mapsto a + c_X^*(b)$ . The splitting is natural with respect to maps in  $\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$ , because for a map of pointed spaces  $f: X \rightarrow Y$  we get commutativity:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & & \xleftarrow{c_X^*} & & & \\
 0 & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(X) & \hookrightarrow & K(X) & \xrightarrow{i_X^*} & K(x_0) \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & \uparrow f^*|_{\tilde{K}(Y)} & & \uparrow f^* & & \uparrow (f|_{x_0})^* \\
 \boxed{\text{diag:kTheo-NaturalSplittin}} & & & & & & \\
 0 & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(Y) & \hookrightarrow & K(Y) & \xrightarrow{i_Y^*} & K(y_0) \longrightarrow 0 \\
 & & & & \uparrow & & \\
 & & & & \xleftarrow{c_Y^*} & & 
 \end{array}$$

The well definition of  $f^*|_{\tilde{K}(Y)}$  follows immediately from the commutativity. The commutativity itself follows from  $\tilde{K}$  being a contravariant functor and all topological maps commute. Finally, define  $\tilde{K}(f) := f^*|_{\tilde{K}(Y)}$  and we are done, since the naturality of the splittings, i.e. commutativity of the diagram in the corollary, then follows from commutativity of each square separately: the left square controls the  $\tilde{K}$ -summand and the right square (together with the sections  $c_X^*, c_Y^*$ ) controls the  $K(x_0)$ -summand.  $\square$

**Remark 4.3.13.** For a map  $f: (X, x_0) \rightarrow (Y, y_0)$  we denote  $\tilde{K}(f)$  and  $K(f)$  by  $f^*$ . The context will make clear if we work in the reduced theory or not.

**Corollary 4.3.14.**  $\tilde{K}$  is a functor from  $\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  to **Ring**.

*Proof.* The proof follows immediately from the naturality of the splitting in Corollary 4.3.12.  $\square$

cor:kTheo-unp  
ointedReduced  
IsNonReduced

**Corollary 4.3.15.** Let  $X$  be a compact hausdorff space, and let

$$F: \mathbf{CWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$$

be the functor that that sends  $X$  to  $(X, [\emptyset])$  with obvious homomorphisms. Then there is a natural isomorphism between the functors  $\tilde{K} \circ F$  and  $K$ .

*Proof.* This follows from the fact that disjoint unions give rise to direct sums of semi rings:  $\text{Vect}(X \sqcup \{\emptyset\}) \cong \text{Vect}(X) \oplus \text{Vect}(\{\emptyset\})$  and the isomorphism is given by gluing the bundles and hence natural. Furthermore, the Grothendieck ring of a direct sum gives the direct sum of rings (again in a natural manner). (This can be verified using the universal property). Hence we get the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(F(X)) & \xrightarrow{\text{inclusion}} & K(F(X)) & \xrightarrow{i^*} & K([\emptyset]) \longrightarrow 0 \\
\parallel & & & & \downarrow \Phi & & \parallel \\
0 & \longrightarrow & K(X) & \xrightarrow{i_1} & K(X) \oplus K([\emptyset]) & \xrightarrow{\pi_2} & K([\emptyset]) \longrightarrow 0
\end{array}$$

But then we can define the map  $\Phi|_{\tilde{K}(F(X))}$  and diagram yoga shows that this is an isomorphism. Furthermore, since  $\Phi$  is natural, the new map is also natural and defines a natural transformation between the two functors.  $\square$

**Definition 4.3.16.** Let  $F : \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2 \rightarrow \mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*$  be the functor that collapses the second space. Then the composition  $\tilde{K} \circ F$  defines a contravariant functor.

**Definition 4.3.17.** Let  $(X, x_0)$  and  $(Y, y_0)$  be two pointed spaces. Then we define the **pointed sum** as:

$$X \vee Y := (X \sqcup Y) / (x_0 \sim y_0).$$

Whith this, we can define the **smash product** as:

$$X \wedge Y := (X \times Y) / (X \vee Y)$$

**Definition 4.3.18.** For the sake of intuition, I want to give a bit of insight into tensor products without beeing to technical and opening the box of pandora of monoidal categories. We define a tensor product in a caregory simply as the space over which bilinear maps factor uniquely. To capture bilinearity in such a categorie wie define the following. Let  $\pi_i : X_0 \times X_1 \rightarrow X_i$  be the canonical projection for  $i = 0, 1$ . Any resonalbe product should come with such surjective maps. Since those are surjective, the  $\pi_i$  omitt a family of right inverses  $r_i : X_i \rightarrow X_0 \times X_1$ . We call such a right inverse "product preserving" if the compositions  $\pi_2 \circ r_1$  and  $\pi_1 \circ r_2$  are constant. Hence the right invers maps into just one fiber. Now bilinearity in this general setting states, that for any product preserving right invers of the projections  $r_i$ , the composition  $f \circ r_i$  is structure preserving.

**Remark 4.3.19** (What is the Smash Product). We can think of the smash product as the tensor product in the pointed topological spaces as follows. Let  $f : (X, x_0) \times (Y, y_0) \rightarrow (Z, z_0)$  be bilinear. For any  $y \in Y$  we have the product preserving right inverse of  $\pi_1$  given by

$$r_1^y : (X, x_0) \rightarrow (X, x_0) \times (Y, y_0), \quad x \mapsto (x, y).$$

Analogously we define  $r_2^x$  for any  $x \in X$  as

$$r_2^x : (Y, y_0) \rightarrow (X, x_0) \times (Y, y_0), \quad y \mapsto (x, y).$$

Now for any  $x \in X$  we have  $f(x, y_0) = f \circ i_Y^x(y_0) = z_0$  as the composition is said to be basepoint preserving. Similar we see that  $f(x_0, y) = z_0$  for any  $y \in Y$ . Hence  $f$  factors over the quotient space

$$X \times Y / (X \times \{y_0\} \cup (Y \times \{x_0\})),$$

where the nominator is the canonically embedded  $X \vee Y$  into the produc. Furtermore by the universal property of quotiens spaces, this factorization is unique.

**Example 4.3.20.** Let  $S^n$  be the  $n$ -dimensional sphere given by all points of norm one in  $\mathbb{R}^{n+1}$ . Then a general fact is that  $S^n \cong I^n / \partial I^n$  and hence for all  $n, m > 0$  we have  $S^n \wedge S^m \cong S^{n+m}$ . Later we will make this homeomorphism canonical. ref

**Definition 4.3.21.** Let  $(X, x_0)$  be a pointed topological space. We define the **reduced suspension** of  $X$  to be

$$\Sigma X := S^1 \wedge X.$$

Furtermore, we define inductively  $\Sigma^n X := \Sigma(\Sigma^{n-1} X) \cong S^n \wedge X$  and using the principle of permanence we extend this definition to  $\Sigma^0 X := S^0 \wedge X \cong X$ . The last homeomorphism is canonical.

**Definition 4.3.22.** Let  $(X, x_0)$  be a pointed topological space. We define the **suspension** of  $X$  to be the space

$$S(X) := X \times I / \sim \quad (5)$$

where  $(x, t) \sim (x', t')$  is  $t = 1$  or  $t = 0$ . Here we identify the top to a point and the bottom to a different point.  $((x, 1) \sim (0, 0))$ . We view  $(S(X), (x, 1))$  as a pointed space.

In general the reduced and unreduced suspension differ. However, under the following condition there will be a natural homotopy equivalence:

lem:kTheo-wel  
lpointedImpli  
esCylinderCof  
ibration

**Lemma 4.3.23.** *If  $(X, x_0)$  is well-pointed, then the inclusion  $\{x_0\} \times I \hookrightarrow S(X)$  is a cofibration.*

*Proof.* This proof is omitted but is Proposition 5.1.16 in [tomDieck2008algebraic]. □

cor:kTheo-red  
ucedSuspensio  
nIsSuspension

**Corollary 4.3.24.** If  $(X, x_0)$  is well pointed, then  $S(X)$  is homotopically equivalent to  $\Sigma(X)$ .

*Proof.* By lemma 4.3.23 we conclude that  $(S(X), x_0 \times I)$  satisfies the homotopy extension property. Hence, by Lemma 2.2.4 we know that  $S(X) \simeq S(X)/x_0 \times I$  and the homeomorphism

$$S(X)/x_0 \times I \cong \Sigma(X)$$

concludes the proof. □

def:kTheo-low  
erKGroub

**Definition 4.3.25** (Lower K-groups). For  $n \geq 0$  we define:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{K}^{-n}(X, x_0) &:= \tilde{K}(\Sigma^n \wedge X) && \text{für } (X, x_0) \in \text{Ob}(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*), \\ K^{-n}(X, Y) &:= \tilde{K}^{-n}(X/Y, [Y]) && \text{für } (X, Y) \in \text{Ob}(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2), \\ K^{-n}(X) &:= K^{-n}(X, \emptyset) && \text{für } X \in \text{Ob}(\mathbf{CWH}). \end{aligned}$$

All those definitions give contravariant and homotopically invariant functors into the category of rings.

cor:kTheo-K(X)  
)listK(X,nix)

**Corollary 4.3.26.** Let  $X$  be a topological space. Then we have a natural isomorphism between the functors  $K^0(X)$  and  $K(X)$ .

*Proof.* When disentangling the definitions, we see that

$$K^0(X) = \tilde{K}(\Sigma^0(X, [\emptyset])) \cong \tilde{K}(X, [\emptyset]) \cong K(X)$$

where the first isomorphism comes from  $\Sigma^0$  beeing canonically isomorphic to the identity and the second isomorphism is given in Corollary 4.3.15.  $\square$

**Remark 4.3.27.** If we have pointed topological spaces  $(X, x_0)$  or pairs  $(X, A)$  and want to denote  $K^0(X, pt)$  or  $K^0(X, A)$  we will often omit the exponent and just write  $K(X, x_0)$  and  $K(X, A)$ .

#### 4.4 Homotopy-Theoretic definition of $K$

def:kTheo-tri  
vialBundleAnd  
LimitInclusin  
os

**Definition 4.4.1.** for any natural number  $n \in \mathbb{N}$  we define  $\underline{n}$  to be the  $n$ -dimensional trivial bundle over a base space  $X$ . With this we define the inclusions

$$i_n : \text{Vect}_n(X) \rightarrow \text{Vect}_{n+1}(X), \quad \xi \mapsto \xi \oplus [\underline{1}],$$

and this gives rise to the direct limit  $\text{colim}_n \text{Vect}_n(X)$ .

**Definition 4.4.2** (Stably Equivalence). Two vector bundles  $E, F$  over the same base space are called **stably equivalent** if there exists an  $n$  such that  $E$  and  $F$  become isomorphic after adding the trivial bundle:

$$E \oplus \underline{n} \cong F \oplus \underline{n}.$$

**Lemma 4.4.3.** In  $K(X)$  two equivalence classes  $[E]$  and  $[F]$  are the same, if and only if  $E$  and  $F$  are stably equivalent.

*Proof.* Assume that two vector bundles satisfy

$$E \oplus \underline{n} \cong F \oplus \underline{n},$$

for some  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ . By abuse of notation we let  $E$  (and  $\underline{n}$ ) denote a vectorbundle and its isomorphismclass simultaneously. Then by Remark 4.3.4

$$[E] = \overline{(E, 0)} = \overline{(E + \underline{n}, \underline{n})} = \overline{(F + \underline{n}, \underline{n})} = \overline{(F, 0)} = [F].$$

On the other hand, if  $[E] = [F]$ , then by the same Remark we can conclude:

$$(E, 0) \sim (F, 0) \Leftrightarrow \text{there exists } G \text{ such that } E \oplus G = F \oplus G.$$

Now by Corollary 4.2.27 we can find a vector bundle  $G'$  such that  $G \oplus G' = \underline{n}$  for some  $n$ . Then

$$E \oplus G \oplus G' = F \oplus G \oplus G' \Rightarrow E \oplus \underline{n} = F \oplus \underline{n}$$

$\square$

**Definition 4.4.4.** We call two vector bundles  $E, F$  over the same base space **eventually equivalent**, if there exist  $n, m \in \mathbb{N}$  such that  $E \oplus n \cong F \oplus m$ .

**Lemma 4.4.5.** *The set of equivalence classes using the notion of eventual equivalence is the limit*

$$\operatorname{colim}_n \operatorname{Vect}_n(X)$$

*Proof.* Let  $\operatorname{EVect}(X)$  be the set of equivalence classes using the notion of eventual equivalence. This satisfies the universal property of the direct limit. To see this let  $f_m : \operatorname{Vect}_m(X) \rightarrow Y$  be a family of maps, that commute with the inclusions  $i_n$  from Definition 4.4.1. From those we define the map

$$f : \operatorname{EVect}(X) \rightarrow Y, \quad [\xi] \mapsto f_{\operatorname{rank}(\xi)}(\xi).$$

This map is well defined, because  $f$  commuting with the inclusions  $i_n$  is equivalent to  $f$  being invariant under eventual equivalence. Uniqueness follows from every element of  $\operatorname{EVect}(X)$  being represented by a vector bundle.  $\square$

**Lemma 4.4.6.** *The set of equivalence classes using the notion of eventual equivalence together with the direct sum is an abelian group*

*Proof.* Everything except inverses is clear. The neutral element is the class of 0. For inverses we take a bundle  $E$  and by Corollary 4.2.27 there exists a  $G$  such that  $E \oplus G \cong \underline{n}$ . Now  $[E] + [G] = [\underline{n}] = [0]$ .  $\square$

lem:kTheorem-  
ucedKisEventu-  
ally

**Lemma 4.4.7.** *For a compact connected space  $X$  there is a natural group isomorphism.*

$$K(X) \cong \mathbb{Z} \times \operatorname{EVect}(X) \cong \mathbb{Z} \times \operatorname{colim}_n \operatorname{Vect}_n(X).$$

*Furthermore if  $(X, p)$  is pointed, there is a natural group isomorphism*

$$\tilde{K}(X) \cong \operatorname{EVect}(X) \cong \operatorname{colim}_n \operatorname{Vect}_n(X).$$

*Proof.* Let  $K$  be an element of  $K(X)$ . Then by Corollary 4.3.3 we can write  $K$  as the difference of two classes of vector bundles  $K = [E] - [F]$ . We abuse the notation of equivalence classes in this proof meaning we won't differentiate between isomorphism classes of vector bundles in  $\operatorname{Vect}_n$ , eventually or stable isomorphism classes or equivalence classes of naturally included vector bundles in  $K(X)$ . The context should always be clear. With this we define the funktion

$$\operatorname{rank}(K) : K(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad K = [E] - [F] \mapsto \operatorname{rank}(E) - \operatorname{rank}(F).$$



This is well defined as if  $K = [E] - [F] = [E'] - [F']$ , then by the relation in  $K(X)$  we know that there is an  $n$  such that

$$E \oplus F' \oplus \underline{n} \cong E' \oplus F \oplus \underline{n}.$$

and hence:

$$\text{rank}(E) - \text{rank}(F) = \text{rank}(E') - \text{rank}(F')$$

Furthermore, rank has a natural right inverse given by

$$r : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow K(X), \quad m \mapsto \begin{cases} [m] - [0] & \text{if } m \geq 0 \\ [0] - [-m] & \text{if } m < 0. \end{cases}$$

Now we claim that the kernel  $\ker(\text{rank}) \cong \text{EVect}(X)$ . For this we define the map

$$\varphi : \text{EVect}(X) \rightarrow K(X), \quad [E] \mapsto [E] - [\underline{\text{rank}(E)}]$$

To see the well definition we assume that  $E$  and  $E'$  are eventually isomorphic and hence there are  $n, n' \in \mathbb{N}$  such that  $E \oplus \underline{n} \cong E' \oplus \underline{n'}$ . But then in  $K(X)$  we have:

$$[E] - [\underline{\text{rank}(E)}] = [E \oplus \underline{n}] - [\underbrace{\underline{\text{rank}(E) \oplus n}}_{=\underline{\text{rank}(F) \oplus n'}}] = [E' \oplus \underline{n'}] - [\underline{\text{rank}(F) \oplus n'}] = [F] - [\underline{\text{rank}(F)}].$$

Obviously  $\text{rank} \circ \varphi \equiv 0$ . To get the other inclusion we first notice the following: Let  $K \in K(X) = [E] - [F]$  be arbitrary. By Corollary 4.2.27 there exists a  $G$  such that  $F \oplus G \cong \underline{n}$  for some  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ . Hence if  $K$  is in the kernel of rank we have:

$$K = [E] - [F] = [E \oplus G] - [\underline{n}] = [E \oplus G] - [\underline{\text{rank}(E \oplus G)}] = \varphi([E \oplus G])$$

This leads to the naturally splitting short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{EVect}(X) \xrightarrow{\varphi} K(X) \xrightarrow[\text{rank}]{r} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

This already proves the isomorphisms

$$K(X) \cong \mathbb{Z} \times \text{EVect}(X) \cong \mathbb{Z} \times \text{colim}_n \text{Vect}_n(X).$$

Now we define the group isomorphism

$$l : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow K(X), \quad m \mapsto \begin{cases} [m] - [0] & \text{if } m \geq 0 \\ [0] - [-m] & \text{if } m < 0. \end{cases}$$

This gives the commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & \text{SVect}(X) & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & K(X) & \xrightarrow[\text{rank}]{r} & \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0 \\
& & & & \downarrow \text{id} & & \downarrow l \\
0 & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(X) & \xrightarrow{\text{inclusion}} & K(X) & \xrightarrow{i^*} & K(p) \longrightarrow 0 \\
& & & & & \nwarrow c_p^* & 
\end{array}$$

Where  $i$  is the inclusion  $\{p\} \rightarrow X$  and  $c_p$  is the collaps  $X \rightarrow \{p\}$ . Then by some diagram chasing the map

$$\tilde{\varphi} : \text{SVect}(X) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(X)$$

is well defined and by the five lemma (add zeros the short sequences on the left) it is an isomorphism.  $\square$

rem:kTheo-ele  
mentsInReduce  
dKtheoryAreGi  
venByEMionusN

**Remark 4.4.8.** In the proof above we have seen that every element of  $k \in K(X)$  is given as the difference of a vector bundle and a trivial bundle  $k = [\xi] - [\underline{n}]$  for some vector bundle  $\xi$  and  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ . We also saw that  $\tilde{K}(X)$  is in the kernal of rank and hence any  $k \in \tilde{K}(X)$  is given by  $k = [\xi] - [\underline{\text{rank}(xi)}]$  where  $\xi$  is a vector bundle.

**Definition 4.4.9.** We define the **unitary group**  $U$  to be the direct limit of the unitary group of rank  $n$  under the standart inclusions

$$U(n) \rightarrow U(n+1), \quad A \mapsto A \oplus \mathbb{1}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

**Definition 4.4.10.** We now want to make  $BU(n)$  into a direct system. Notationally, this proof will have many maps with two indices. The convention is that lower indices show for which colimit the maps form a directed system. As an example, the maps  $i_m^n$  are used for the colimit over  $m$ . We start with the the inclusion

$$j_m : \mathbb{C}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{m+1}, \quad (x) \mapsto (x, 0),$$

which gives rise to the maps

$$f_n^m : \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow \text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^{m+1}), \quad V \mapsto j_m(V).$$

Those inclusions commute with the maps

$$i_m^n : \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow \text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m+1}), \quad V \mapsto V \oplus \langle e_{m+1} \rangle$$

from the direct system from corollar 4.2.39. If we denote the inclusion of  $\varphi_m^{n+1} : \text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow \text{colim}_m(\text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^m))$  we get the following commuting diagram, for all  $n \leq m$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) & \xrightarrow{f_n^m} & \text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^{m+1}) & \xrightarrow{\varphi_{m+1}^{n+1}} & \text{colim}_m(\text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^m)) = BU(n+1) \\
\downarrow i_m^n & & \downarrow i_m^n & \nearrow \varphi_{m+2}^{n+1} & \\
\text{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^{m+1}) & \xrightarrow{f_n^{m+1}} & \text{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^{m+2}) & & 
\end{array}$$

Now for all  $n$  we use the universal property of the direct limit  $\operatorname{colim}_m(\operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m))$  on the family

$$\left( \varphi_{m+1}^{n+1} \circ f_n^m : \operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow BU(n+1) \right)_m$$

to induce maps  $f_n : BU(n) \rightarrow BU(n+1)$ . which in turn give us a directed system and lets us define:

$$BU := \operatorname{colim}_n BU(n) = \operatorname{colim}_n \left( \operatorname{colim}_m \operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) \right).$$

**Lemma 4.4.11.** *The maps  $f_n : BU(n) \rightarrow BU(n+1)$  are closed embeddings.*

*Proof.* Since  $\operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m)$  is compact and Hausdorff for any  $n \leq m$  the maps  $f_n^m$  are closed embeddings. Furthermore, the natural maps  $\varphi_m^n : \operatorname{Gr}_n(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow BU(n)$  are also closed embeddings. Now assume that  $f_n(x) = f_n(x')$ . Then for  $r$  big enough (omitting the inclusions)  $f_n^r(x) = f_n^r(x')$  which contradicts the injectivity of the  $f_n^r(x)$ . Now we want to show that  $f_n$  have a closed image. For this we let  $C := \operatorname{im} f_n \subset BU(n+1)$  and call the natural inclusions  $\varphi_m^{n+1} : \operatorname{Gr}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C}^m) \rightarrow BU(n+1)$ . Then  $C$  is closed, if and only if  $C \cap \operatorname{im} \varphi_m^{n+1}$  is closed for all  $m > n$ . To show this we first show that  $C \cap \operatorname{im} \varphi_m^{n+1} = \operatorname{im} \varphi_m^{n+1} \circ f_n^{m-1}$ . The first inclusion  $\subseteq$  is clear. The other inclusion follows directly from the constructino of  $f_n$  that satisfies  $f_n \circ \varphi_{m-1}^n = \varphi_m^{n+1} \circ f_n^{m-1}$ . By Remark 4.2.38 we know that  $\varphi_m^{n+1} \circ f_n^{m-1}$  is a closed embedding hence  $C \cap \operatorname{im} \varphi_m^{n+1}$  is closed for all  $m > n$  and hence  $C$  is closed. Now finally we need to show that  $f_n$  are homeomorphisms onto their image. For this we show that they are closed maps, meaning they map closed sets to closed sets. This property together with injectivity implies the closed embedding property. Let  $U \subset BU(n)$  be closed. By construction of the direkt limit we can wirte  $U = \bigcup_m (\operatorname{im}(\varphi_m^n) \cap U) = \bigcup_m (\varphi_m^n(U_m))$ , where  $U_m := (\varphi_m^n)^{-1}(U)$ . Now by the same argument as befor we have the equality  $f_n(U) \cap \operatorname{im} \varphi_{m+1}^{n+1} = \varphi_{m+1}^{n+1} \circ f_n^m(U_m)$ . This is closed for all  $m$  because the maps  $\varphi_{m+1}^{n+1}$  and  $f_n^m$  are closed embeddings and hence closed. But then  $f_n(U)$  is closed in the final topology and hence  $f_n$  is an closed embedding.  $\square$

thm:kTheo-red  
ucedKgroupAsH  
omotopy

**Theorem 4.4.12.** *For a connected pointed space  $X$  we have a natural homomorphism*

$$\tilde{K}(X) \cong [X, BU]$$

*Proof.* We can now interchange the homotopy classes of maps and the limit by Lemma 4.2.41:

$$\begin{aligned} [X, BU] &= [X, \operatorname{colim}_n (BU(n))] \\ &\cong \operatorname{colim}_n \operatorname{Vect}_n(X) && \text{by Corollary 4.2.43,} \\ &\cong \tilde{K}(X) && \text{by Lemma 4.4.7.} \end{aligned}$$

$\square$

lemma:kTheo-  
generalGroupCo  
ntractsToUnit  
ary

**Lemma 4.4.13.** *The general linear Group  $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  retracts onto the unitary Group  $U(n)$  and the retraction commutes with the inclusions  $A \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ .*

*Proof.* Let  $A \in \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ . Then  $A^*A$  is a positive-definite Hermitian matrix, since for  $v \in \mathbb{C}^n$ :

$$v^* A^* A v = (Av)^* (Av) = \|Av\|^2 \geq 0.$$

Hence, it is diagonalizable with real non negative eigenvalues  $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n > 0$ . We define  $P_1 := \sqrt{A^*A}$  to be the matrix, that scales all eigenspaces by  $\sqrt{\lambda_i}$ . Then  $P^2 = A^*A$ , and  $\sqrt{A^*A}$  is also positive definite Hermitian, as all eigenvalues are positive and hence, it is invertable. Notice, that

$$\sqrt{\begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}^* \begin{pmatrix} A & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{A^*A} & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

We then define  $U_A := A(P_A)^{-1}$ . By definition  $A = U_A P_A$ , and since  $P_A$  is Hermitian,  $P_A^{-1}$  is also hermitan letting us conclude that  $U_A$  is unitary.

$$U_A^* U_A = ((P_A)^{-1})^* \underbrace{A^* A}_{P_A^2} (P_A)^{-1} = \mathbb{1}.$$

Notice again, that for  $\tilde{A} = A \oplus \mathbb{1}_1 \in \mathrm{GL}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C})$ , we have  $U_{\tilde{A}} = U_A \oplus \mathbb{1}_1 \in U(n+1)$ . Now the space of positive-definite Hermitian matrixes is convex. This is just a calculation of all the axioms for the matrixes on the connecting line of two positive-definit Hermitian matrixes. But as a convex space, it is contractible.  $\square$

lem:kTheo-red  
ucedSuspended  
KGroupHomotop  
ically

**Lemma 4.4.14.** *For a connected pointed space  $X$  with well sitting basepoint, we have a natural homomorphism*

$$\tilde{K}(\Sigma X) \cong [X, U]$$

*The group structure in  $[X, U]$  comes from viewing  $[X, U]$  as the direct limit of abelian groups  $\mathrm{colim}[X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})]$ , where the group structure is derived from the one in  $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ .*

*Proof.* If the base point is well sitting, we can apply Corollary 4.3.24, which gives us the homotopy equivalence

$$\Sigma X \simeq S(X).$$

Now  $S(X)$  itself can be cut into two contractible cones

$$\begin{aligned} C_+(X) &:= \{(x, t) \in S(X) \mid t \geq \tfrac{1}{2}\} \\ C_-(X) &:= \{(x, t) \in S(X) \mid t \leq \tfrac{1}{2}\}. \end{aligned}$$

Those cones intersect in  $C_+ \cap C_- = X \times \{\tfrac{1}{2}\} \cong X$ . Now denote the trivial  $n$  bundle over  $C_+(X)$  by  $\underline{n}_+$  and over  $C_-(X)$  by  $\underline{n}_-$ . With this notation we know by the proof of Lemma 4.2.15 that the map

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi_n : [X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})] &\rightarrow \mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X) \\ f &\mapsto \underline{n}_+ \bigcup_f \underline{n}_- \end{aligned} \tag{6}$$

$\{\text{eq:kTheo-SXt}$   
 $\text{oHomotoy}\}$

in an bijection for all  $n$ . Furthermore, the inclusion of  $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$  into  $\mathrm{GL}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C})$  gives an inclusion  $[X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})]$  into  $[X, \mathrm{GL}_{n+1}(\mathbb{C})]$  which commutes with the inclusion  $\mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X)$  into  $\mathrm{Vect}_{n+1}(\Sigma X)$  under the bijection (6) meaning that for any  $n \leq m$  the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})] & \xrightarrow{\varphi_n} & \mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X) \\ \downarrow i_{nm} & & \downarrow i_{nm} \\ [X, \mathrm{GL}_m(\mathbb{C})] & \xrightarrow{\varphi_m} & \mathrm{Vect}_m(\Sigma X) \end{array}$$

commutes. Lemma 4.4.7 gives us

$$\tilde{K}(X) \cong \mathrm{colim}_n [X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})] \cong [X, \mathrm{colim}_n \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})].$$

The latter bijection follows from Lemma 4.2.41. Finally, Lemma 4.4.13 gives us a retraction  $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) \rightarrow U(n)$  that commutes with the inclusions and hence we get the same direct limit.

$$[X, \mathrm{colim}_n \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})] \cong [X, \mathrm{colim}_n U(n)] = [X, U]$$

concluding that we have a natural bijection. To get the group structure we need to look into said mapping. For this we inspect the mapping (6) closer. Let

$$\Phi_n : [X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})] \rightarrow \mathrm{colim} \mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X)$$

be the composition of  $\varphi_n$  with the inclusion  $\mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X) \rightarrow \mathrm{colim} \mathrm{Vect}_n(\Sigma X)$ . By the commutative diagram above, the maps  $\varphi_n$  induce a map from  $\mathrm{colim} [X, \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})]$  which is a group homomorphism, if all  $\Phi_n$  are one. Hence take two functions  $f, g : X \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ . then by definition

$$f \oplus g : X \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}), \quad x \mapsto f(x) \times g(x)$$

Now  $f \oplus g$  can be included into  $[X, \mathrm{GL}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})]$ :

$$f \oplus g : X \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}), \quad x \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} f(x) \times g(x) & 0 \\ 0 & \mathbb{1}_n \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now we have that  $f \oplus g$  is homotopic to

$$\widetilde{f \oplus g} : X \rightarrow X \rightarrow GL_{2n}(\mathbb{C}), \quad x \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} f(x) & 0 \\ 0 & g(x) \end{pmatrix}$$

via the homotopy  $\rho_t(x)$  for  $t \in (0, \frac{\pi}{2})$ :

$$\rho_t(x) = \begin{pmatrix} f(x) & 0 \\ 0 & \mathbb{1}_n \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos(t) & \sin(t) \\ \sin(t) & \cos(t) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{1}_n & 0 \\ 0 & g(x) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos(t) & \sin(t) \\ \sin(t) & \cos(t) \end{pmatrix} \quad (7)$$

{eq:kTheo-hom  
otopyBetween  
irectSumAndPr  
oduct}

Finally we can look at the image of  $[f \oplus g] = [\widetilde{f \oplus g}]$  under  $\Phi_{2n}$  which is given by inclusion of

$$\varphi_n([\widetilde{f \oplus g}]) = \underline{n}_+ \oplus \underline{n}_+ \bigcup_{\widetilde{f \oplus g}} \underline{n}_- \oplus \underline{n}_- = [\varphi_n(f) \oplus \varphi_n(g)]$$

into the colimit, where the equation

$$[\varphi_n(f) \oplus \varphi_n(g)] = [\varphi_n(f)] \oplus [\varphi_n(g)]$$

holds. The second last equality follows from the properties of the gluing construction given in Corollary 4.2.12.  $\square$

**Remark 4.4.15.** The proof of Lemma 4.4.14 gives a slightly more general statement: For a connected well pointed topological space  $(X, x_0)$  with a splitting into two contractible parts  $X^+$  and  $x^-$  with  $x_0 \in A := X^+ \cap X^-$  and  $X^+ \cup X^- = X$  and the inclusion of  $A$  into the two contractible parts are cofibrations, there is a natural group isomorphism

$$[A, U] \cong \tilde{K}(X)$$

lem:kTheo-inv  
ersedInKGiven  
ByHomotopical  
lyMethods

**Lemma 4.4.16.** *Let  $Y$  be a pointed space. Define*

$$T : S^1 \rightarrow S^1 \\ t \mapsto 1 - t$$

*and let  $\Sigma T : SY \rightarrow SY$  be the map induced by  $T$  on  $S^1$  and the identity on  $Y$ . Then:*

$$(\Sigma T)^* : \tilde{K}(SY) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(SY) \\ y \mapsto -y$$

*Proof.* We have the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \tilde{K}(SX) & \longleftarrow & \text{colim}[Y, GL(n, \mathbb{C})] \\ (\Sigma T)^* \downarrow & & \downarrow f \mapsto f^{-1}(\text{pointwise}) \\ \tilde{K}(SX) & \longleftarrow & \text{colim}[Y, GL(n, \mathbb{C})] \end{array}$$

To see why this commutes, notice how we defined the map by gluing via  $f$ , where  $\Sigma T$  changes the place of the upper and lower vector bundle. Hence the gluing function needed is now the inverse. The horizontal maps are natural group homomorphisms and on the right side the inverse is taken. Thereby the commutativity tells us that the left side is also the same as taking the inverse.  $\square$

ex:kTheo-Line  
BundlesSatlqu  
adequalslPlus  
1

**Example 4.4.17.** Let  $l$  and  $l'$  be line bundles over  $S^2$ . Then the clutching function for the vector bundle  $l \otimes l'$  is given by the tensor product of clutching functions. So let  $f$  and  $f'$  be two clutching functions

$$f, f' : S \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C})$$

Then the product bundle  $l \otimes l'$  is given by the clutching function

$$f \otimes f' : S \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(\mathbb{C} \otimes \mathbb{C}) \cong \mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C}), \quad x \mapsto f(x)f'(x)$$

Hence, the product in  $\tilde{K}(S^2)$  is given by  $f \otimes f' = f \cdot f'$ . Now, the homotopy (7) of the proof above shows that  $f \cdot f' \oplus \mathrm{id}_1 \simeq f \oplus f'$  and hence  $l \otimes l' \oplus \underline{1} \cong l \oplus l'$ .

**Proposition 4.4.18.** For compactly generated pointed Hausdorff spaces  $(X, x_0), (Y, y_0)$  there is a natural bijection

$$[SX, Y] \rightarrow [X, \Omega Y],$$

where  $\Omega$  denotes the loop space

$$\Omega Y := \{f : S^1 \rightarrow Y \mid f \text{ continuous and } f(1) = y_0\}.$$

together with the compact open topology.

*Proof.* For any three  $(X, x_0), (Y, y_0), (Z, z_0)$  we have that a basepoint preserving map  $f : X \wedge Y \rightarrow Z$  can be lifted to a map  $\tilde{f} : X \times Y \rightarrow Z; \tilde{f}(z) = \tilde{f}(\bar{z})$  that maps the whole  $X \vee Y$  to  $z_0$ . This map is continuous by the universal property of the quotient topology. Hence we get a bijection

$$C(X \wedge Y, Z) \rightarrow \{f \in C(X \times Y, Z) \mid f|_{X \vee Y} \equiv z_0\}$$

its inverse is given by the quotient induced maps. We can compose this map with the natural currying map  $C(X \times Y, Z) \rightarrow C(X, C(Y, Z))$ . For  $Y = S$  we gain a map

$$C(SX, Z) \rightarrow C(X, \Omega Z)$$

that is again a bijection, since any  $f : X \rightarrow \Omega Z$  gives a map  $\tilde{f} : X \times S \rightarrow Z; \tilde{f}(x, s) \mapsto f(x)(s)$ . If  $(x, s) \in X \vee S \subseteq X \times S$ , then either  $x = x_0$  or  $s = 1$ . In the first case,  $f(x_0)$  is the constant loop and hence  $f(x_0)(s) = z_0$  and in the second case we evaluate a based loop at its base and hence  $f(x)(1) = z_0$ . Hence, the  $\tilde{f}$  factors over  $X \vee S$  giving a well defined element in  $C(SX, Z)$ . This is its inverse. The continuity part of the argument follows from Proposition 2.3.3.  $\square$

**Remark 4.4.19.** By Theorem 4.4.12, and the Proposition above we know that for a connected pointed compact space we have

$$\tilde{K}(SX) \cong [SX, BU] \cong [X, \Omega BU]$$

On the other hand we have Lemma 4.4.14 which tells us that

$$\tilde{K}(SX) \cong [X, U].$$

This hints at a connection that states that  $\Omega BU$  is homotopically equivalent to  $U$ :

## 4.5 K-Theory as a Cohomology Theory

This chapter aims to give the definitions and theorems that makes K theory an axiomatic cohomology theory as defined by Eilenberg and Steenrod. For this we start trying to find a long exact sequence and on the way we will proof the additivity:

lem:kTheo-exa  
ctShortPartFo  
rThePair

**Lemma 4.5.1.** *Let  $(X, Y) \in \text{ob}(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2)$  and define  $i : (Y, \emptyset) \rightarrow (X, \emptyset)$  and  $j : (X, \emptyset) \rightarrow (X, Y)$  to be the inclusions. Then we have an exact sequence:*

$$K(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} K(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} K(Y)$$

*Here, we identify  $K(X) = K(X, \emptyset)$  and the same with  $K(Y) = K(Y, \emptyset)$  such that we have well defined induced functions from the same functor in the sequence. This is just a formall note, as  $K(X, \emptyset) \cong K(X)$  by Corollary 4.3.26.*

*Proof.* First, we show that  $\text{im}(i^*) \subseteq \ker(j^*)$ . To see this, notice that  $i^* \circ j^* = (j \circ i)^*$ , and  $j \circ i$  factors over  $(Y, Y)$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (Y, \emptyset) & \xrightarrow{i} & (X, \emptyset) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow j \\ (Y, Y) & \longrightarrow & (X, Y) \end{array}$$

Hence,  $j^* \circ i^*$  factors over the trivial ring  $K(Y, Y)$  and thereby is trivial. Now suppose  $k \in \ker(i^*)$ . The intuition now is that if we have a vector bundle that gets mapped to 0 this means that it is trivial over  $Y$  which lets us define a vector bundle over the quotient  $X/Y$  by a trivialization: We write  $k = [\xi] - [\underline{n}]$  for  $\xi$  being a vector bundle over  $X$ . (Compare Remark 4.4.8) Since  $i^* \xi = 0$  it follows that  $i^*([\xi] - [\underline{n}]) = [\xi|_Y] - [\underline{n}|_Y] = 0$  and hence  $E$  and  $n$  are stably equivalent over  $Y$  giving us an  $m$  such that

$$(\xi \oplus \underline{m})|_Y \cong \xi|_Y \oplus \underline{m} \cong \underline{n} \oplus \underline{m}$$

Hence, there is a trivialization  $\alpha : (\xi \oplus \underline{m})|_Y \rightarrow Y \times \mathbb{C}^{\text{rank}(\xi)+m}$  that defines a bundle  $(\xi \oplus \underline{m})|_Y / \alpha$  as shown in the proof of Lemma 4.2.7 over  $X/Y$ . Now we define

$$\eta = [(\xi \oplus \underline{m})|_Y / \alpha] - [\underline{n} + \underline{m}] \in \tilde{K}(X/Y) = K(X, Y)$$



and since the trivialization acts as a right inverse of the pullback of the restriction (compare Corollary 4.2.8)

$$j^*(\eta) = [\xi \oplus \underline{m}] - [\underline{n} + \underline{m}] = k.$$

□

lem:kTheo-poi  
ntedUnionExac  
tSequence

**Lemma 4.5.2.** *Let  $X, Y$  be pointed topological spaces and define the maps*

*$i : X \rightarrow X \vee Y$  the inclusion, and  $j : X \vee Y \rightarrow Y$  the collaps of  $X$ .*

*Then the sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \tilde{K}(X) \xrightarrow{j^*} \tilde{K}(X \vee Y) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}(Y) \longrightarrow 0$$

*is exact and naturally splits via the map  $q^*$ , that is a right inverse of  $j^*$ , where  $q : X \vee Y \rightarrow Y$  is the collaps.*

*Proof.* Notice how there is a natural homeomorphism  $X \cong (X \vee Y)/Y$ . Hence, Lemma 4.5.1 provides the exactnes at  $\tilde{K}(X \vee Y)$ . Now the map  $q$  is a left inverse of  $j$  as continuous maps, and hence  $q^*$  is a right inverse of  $j^*$  in the K group, proofing the injectivity of  $j^*$ . now only the surjectivity of  $i^*$  is missing. However the inclusion  $l : Y \rightarrow X \vee Y$  is a topological right inverse of  $i$  and thereby  $l^*$  is a left inverse of  $i^*$  giving us the injectivity and hence proofing the exactness and splitting of the short exact sequence. □

thm:kTheo-poi  
ntedAdditiv  
y

**Theorem 4.5.3** (Pointed Additivity). *Let  $X, Y$  be pointed topological spaces and denote the inclusions of  $X$  (resp.  $Y$ ) into  $X \vee Y$  by  $i_X$  (resp.  $i_Y$ ). Then the map*

$$i_X^* \oplus i_Y^* : \tilde{K}(X \vee Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(X) \oplus \tilde{K}(Y)$$

*is a natural isomorphism with inverse*

$$\psi : \tilde{K}(X) \oplus \tilde{K}(Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(X \vee Y), \quad (x, y) \mapsto c_X^*(x) + c_Y^*(y),$$

*where  $c_X$  (resp.  $c_Y$ ) denotes the collaps of  $X$  (hence onto  $Y$ ) respectifly the collaps of  $Y$  and hence onto  $X$ .*

*Proof.* This is a direct consequence of Lemma 4.5.2 and the algebraic mashinery of splitting short exact sequences. □

thm:kTheo-unp  
ointedAdditiv  
ity

**Corollary 4.5.4** (Unpointed Additivity). *Let  $X, Y$  be topological spaces, then there is a natural isomorphism*

$$K(X \sqcup Y) \rightarrow K(X) \oplus K(Y)$$

*Proof.* This follows from  $K(A) \cong \tilde{K}(A, [\emptyset])$  for all topological spaces. Furthermore,  $(X \sqcup Y, [\emptyset]) \cong ((X, [\emptyset]) \vee (Y, [\emptyset]))$ . Hence, using those isomorphisms, the statement is a direct consequence of the pointed additivity.  $\square$

**Corollary 4.5.5.** If  $(X, Y) \in ob(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2)$  and  $Y \in ob(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^*)$  such that  $X$  is pointed by using the base point  $y_0$  from  $Y$ . Then the sequence

$$K(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} \tilde{K}(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}(Y)$$

is exact.

*Proof.* We have the commutative diagram with exact top row:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K(X, Y) & \longrightarrow & K(X) & \longrightarrow & K(Y) \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \cong & & \downarrow \cong \\ & & \tilde{K}(X) \oplus K(y_0) & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(Y) \oplus K(y_0) \\ & & \downarrow \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ & & \tilde{K}(X) & \longrightarrow & \tilde{K}(Y) \end{array}$$

The middle horizontal map is a map that respects the grading, since we have the same base point. With this we can do a bit of diagram yoga concluding the statement.  $\square$

**Definition 4.5.6.** Let  $X$  be a topological space and  $I = [0, 1]$  be the unit interval. We define the cone over  $X$  to be the space

$$CX := (X \times I) / X \times \{0\}.$$

Let  $(X, Y)$  be a pair of compact topological spaces. We define the cone over the subspace  $Y$  to be

$$(X \sqcup CY) / Y \sim Y \times \{1\}$$

and denote that with  $(X \cup CY)$ .

**Proposition 4.5.7.** If we define for  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  the induced maps on the cones  $Cf$  by

$$Cf : CX \rightarrow CY \quad \overline{(x, t)} \mapsto \overline{(f(x), t)},$$

the cone defines a functor  $\mathbf{CGWH} \rightarrow \mathbf{TopP}$ . The cone over  $Y \subseteq X$  defines in similar fashion an functor from  $\mathbf{CGWH}_{\text{cof}}^2$  to  $\mathbf{TopP}$ . There is a natural isomorphism:

$$T : (X \cup CY) / X \rightarrow CY / Y$$

Here, the left and right hand side both define Functors from  $\mathbf{CGWH}_{\text{cof}}^2$  to  $\mathbf{TopP}$  with the obvious morphisms. Furthermore, we have that  $CY/Y$  is homotopically equivalent to  $\Sigma Y$  which is homotopically equivalent to  $SY$  as long as  $(Y, y_0)$  is well pointed. All the equivalences are natural up to homotopy.

cor:kTheo-exa  
ctnesOfTheRed  
ucedInclusion  
Sequence

def:kTheo-con  
eOverSubspace

**Corollary 4.5.8.** From the considerations above we get a natural isomorphism

$$\theta : K(X \cup CY, Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(SY) = \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y).$$

def:kTheo-connectingHomomorphism

**Definition 4.5.9** (Connecting Homomorphism). Let  $(X, Y)$  be a topological pair of compact spaces and  $Y$  be pointed. Define the two maps

$$m : (X \cup CY, \emptyset) \rightarrow (X \cup CY, X) \quad (8)$$

$$\pi : (X \cup CY, \emptyset) \rightarrow X/Y \quad (9)$$

where  $m$  is the inclusion in the second space, and  $\pi$  is the collaps of  $CY$ . Since  $CY$  is contractible, the induced map  $\pi^* : \tilde{K}(X/Y) \rightarrow K(X \cup CY, \emptyset)$  is an isomorphism by Lemma 4.2.10. Together with the isomorphism

$$\theta : K(X \cup CY, Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(SY) = \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y).$$

We define the connecting homomorphism

$$\delta := (\pi^*)^{-1} \circ m^* \circ \theta^{-1} : \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \rightarrow K(X, Y)$$

thm:kTheo-longExactSequence

**Theorem 4.5.10** (Long Exact Sequence). *For  $(X, Y) \in \text{ob}(\mathbf{CWH}_{\text{cof}}^2)$  we have a natural exact sequence that is infinite to the left:*

$$\begin{aligned} \dots \longrightarrow K^{-2}(Y) &\xrightarrow{\delta} K^{-1}(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} K^{-1}(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} K^{-1}(Y) \\ &\xrightarrow{\delta} K^0(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} K^0(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} K^0(Y) \end{aligned}$$

*The maps  $i^*$  are induced by the inclusion  $i : Y \rightarrow X$ ,  $j^*$  are induced by the inclusion  $j : (X, \emptyset) \rightarrow (X, Y)$  and  $\delta$  is the connecting homomorphism. For the lower degrees,  $\delta$  is the connecting homomorphism where  $X$  and  $Y$  are replaced by the reduced suspensions of  $X$  and  $Y$ .*

*Proof.* We will proof the pointed version of the theorem, that states that for a compact pair  $(X, Y)$  such that  $Y$  is itself compact pointed (and  $X$  is pointed with the same basepoint) we have the exact sequence (infinite to the left):

$$\begin{aligned} \dots \longrightarrow \tilde{K}^{-2}(Y) &\xrightarrow{\delta} K^{-1}(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} \tilde{K}^{-1}(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \\ &\xrightarrow{\delta} K^0(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} \tilde{K}^0(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}^0(Y) \end{aligned}$$

The pointed sequence induced the statement for unpointed spaces because for any topological space  $A$  we have a natural isomorphism  $\tilde{K}(A, [\emptyset]) \cong K(A)$ .

We will furthermore just proof the exactnes of the segment:

$$\tilde{K}^{-1}(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \xrightarrow{\delta} K^0(X, Y) \xrightarrow{j^*} \tilde{K}^0(X) \xrightarrow{i^*} \tilde{K}^0(Y) \quad (10)$$

{eq:kTheo-pro  
ofSesShortAnd  
reducedSequen  
ce}

From this we reegain the long sequence by replacing  $(X)$  and  $Y$  with  $S^n(X)$  and  $S^n Y$ .

In  $\tilde{K}^0(X)$ , the exactnes was shown in Corollary 4.5.5. To get the exactnes at the other spots we apply the same corollary to the pairs:

- $(X \cup CY, X)$
- $((X \cup CY) \cup CX, X \cup CY)$

For the middle part we have the commutative diagram where the naming of the maps is the same as in the definition of the connecting homomorphims (Definition 4.5.9).

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K(X \cup CY, X) & \xrightarrow{m^*} & \tilde{K}(X \cup CY) & \xrightarrow{k^*} & \tilde{K}(X) \\ \downarrow \theta & & \uparrow \pi^* & & \downarrow \text{id} \\ K^{-1}(Y) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & K(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{j^*} & \tilde{K}(X) \end{array}$$

The commutativity in the left square is the definition of  $\delta$  and in the right square follows from  $\pi \circ k = j : X \rightarrow X/Y$ . Since all vertical maps are isomorphisms, Corollary 4.5.5 implies exactnes in the bottom row  $K(X, Y)$ . Now only the exactness in the first three terms is missing. For this we look at the pair  $((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X, X \cup C_1 Y)$ , where the  $C_i$  are cones and denoted with the index to distinguish the cones. First we get again an exact sequence:

$$K((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X, X \cup C_1 Y) \xrightarrow{l^*} \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X) \xrightarrow{s^*} \tilde{K}(X \cup C_1 Y)$$

Our goals is now to show that we commute with the start of the exact sequence (10), hence to finde vertical maps between the top rows (denoted with "?" in the diagram below) such that the diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X, X \cup C_1 Y) & \xrightarrow{l^*} & \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X) & \xrightarrow{s^*} & \tilde{K}(X \cup C_1 Y) \\ \downarrow ? & & \downarrow ? & & \downarrow ? \\ \tilde{K}^{-1}(X) & \xrightarrow{i^*} & \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & K(X, Y) \end{array}$$

We start with the right square and notice that by definition we get a commutative diagramm:

The bot-  
tom row  
is added  
for clear-  
ification  
on what  
inclusion  
induces  
 $i^*$ .. besser  
erklären

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
K(X \cup C_1Y \cup C_2X) & \xrightarrow{s^*} & \tilde{K}(X \cup C_1Y) \\
\downarrow (\tilde{\pi}^*)^{-1} & & \downarrow \text{id} \\
K(X \cup C_1Y, X) & \xrightarrow{m^*} & \tilde{K}(X \cup C_1Y) \\
\downarrow \theta & & \downarrow (\pi^*)^{-1} \\
K^{-1}(Y) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & K(X, Y)
\end{array}$$

The bottom square commutes by definition. In the top square, the map  $\tilde{\pi}$  denotes the collapsing map  $X \cup C_1Y \cup C_2X \rightarrow (X \cup C_1Y)/X$ . To see the commutativity in the top square notice how  $\tilde{\pi}^* \circ s^* = (s \circ \tilde{\pi})^*$  and the maps  $m$  and  $s \circ \tilde{\pi}$  coincide and hence the top square commutes. For the left square, a natural choice is the homotopically equivalence given by quotienting second space of the pair  $(X \cup C_1Y) \cup C_2X, X \cup C_1Y$  to get:

$$\left( (X \cup C_1Y) \cup C_2X / X \cup C_1Y \right) \cong (C_2X/X) \simeq S(Y).$$

We now have all the unknown maps, but we run into a Problem, since the map  $l^*$  induces a map  $\lambda$  by the “wrong” inclusions (compared to  $i^*$  which is induced by the inclusion  $C_2Y \rightarrow C_2X$ , whereas we have  $C_1Y$ ). This is depicted in the non-commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
K((X \cup C_1Y) \cup C_2X, X \cup C_1Y) & \xrightarrow{l^*} & \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1Y) \cup C_2X) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\tilde{K}(C_2X/X) \cong \tilde{K}^{-1}(X) & \xrightarrow{\lambda} & \tilde{K}(C_1Y/Y) \cong \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \\
\uparrow & & \uparrow \\
K(C_2X, X) & \xrightarrow{i^*} & K(C_2Y, Y)
\end{array}$$

To resolve that problem we introduce the double cone on  $Y$  namely  $C_1Y \cup C_2Y$ , that fits into the commutative diagram where all unnamed maps are the natural ones:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
X \cup C_1Y \cup C_2X & \xRightarrow{\quad} & C_1Y/Y & \xRightarrow{\quad} & \Sigma Y \\
\downarrow & \swarrow & \uparrow & \searrow & \vdots \Sigma T \\
& & C_1Y \cup C_2Y & & \\
& \swarrow & \downarrow & \searrow & \\
C_2X/X & \xleftarrow{\quad} & C_2Y/Y & \xRightarrow{\quad} & \Sigma Y
\end{array}$$

The double arrows always induce isomorphisms in the  $K$ -Rings and the map  $\Sigma T$  is one we want to construct. For said construction we formulate the following Lemma:

lem:kTheo-doubleConeFlip

**Lemma 4.5.11.** *Let  $Y$  be a wellpointed space and denote the points of  $CY$  and*

$\Sigma Y$  by  $(x, t)$  such that  $CY$  has the apex  $[\{0\} \times Y]$  and base  $\{1\} \times Y \cong Y$ . Let

$$D := C_1Y \cup C_2Y = (C_1Y \sqcup C_2Y) / ((x, 1)_1 \sim (x, 1)_2)$$

denote the double cone glued along a common base. Now define the maps

- $c_i : D \rightarrow C_iY/Y$  the collaps of the complementary cone  $C_jY$   $j \neq i$ .
- $\bar{\pi}_1 : C_iY/Y \rightarrow \Sigma Y \quad [(x, t)] \mapsto (x, t)$ .
- $p_i := \bar{\pi}_1 \circ c_i : D \rightarrow \Sigma Y$ .
- $R : D \rightarrow D \quad (x, t)_i \mapsto (x, t)_j$  where  $j \neq i$ , the cone swap.
- $\Sigma T : \Sigma Y \rightarrow \Sigma Y, \quad (x, t) \mapsto (x, 1 - t)$  the suspension flip.
- $\Phi : D \rightarrow \Sigma Y, \quad (x, t)_1 \mapsto (x, 1 - \frac{t}{2}), \quad (x, t)_2 \mapsto (x, \frac{t}{2})$ .

Then we have have that

$$p_2 = p_1 \circ R \quad \text{and} \quad \Phi \circ R = \Sigma T \circ \Phi.$$

*Proof of Lemma 4.5.11.* The first statement  $p_2 = p_1 \circ R$  is clear, as:

$$\begin{aligned} p_2(x, t)_2 &= [(x, t)] = p_1(x, t)_1 = p_1 \circ R(x, t)_2, \quad \text{and} \\ p_2(x, t)_1 &= [\{1\} \times Y] = p_1(x, t)_2 = p_1 \circ R(x, t)_1. \end{aligned}$$

Similar, the second statement is also just a calculation:

$$\begin{aligned} \Sigma T \circ \Phi(x, t)_1 &= \Sigma T(x, 1 - \frac{t}{2}) = (x, \frac{t}{2}) = \Phi(x, t)_2 = \varphi \circ R(x, t)_1 \\ \Sigma T \circ \Phi(x, t)_2 &= \Sigma T(x, \frac{t}{2}) = (x, 1 - \frac{t}{2}) = \Phi(x, t)_1 = \varphi \circ R(x, t)_2. \end{aligned}$$

□

By the lemma above, we know that  $\Sigma T$  makes the diagramm commute and by Lemma 4.4.16 we know that

$$(\Sigma T)^* : \tilde{K}(\Sigma Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}(\Sigma Y)$$

is multiplication by minus one. Hence, the diagramm

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X \cup C_1Y \cup C_2X & \xrightarrow{\quad\quad\quad} & K(C_1Y/Y) & \longleftarrow & \tilde{K}(\Sigma Y) \\ & \searrow & \swarrow & & \uparrow \\ & & K(C_1Y \cup C_2Y) & & \uparrow \\ & & \swarrow & & \uparrow \\ & & K(C_2Y/Y) & \longleftarrow & \tilde{K}(\Sigma Y) \end{array}$$

$\begin{array}{c} \uparrow \\ (-1)^* \\ \uparrow \end{array}$

is commutative and recall that all maps are isomorphisms. That tells us, that the two maps

$$\begin{aligned} r_1^* : \tilde{K}(C_1 Y / Y) &\cong \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X) \\ r_2^* : \tilde{K}(C_2 Y / Y) &\cong \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) \rightarrow \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X) \end{aligned}$$

commute up to sign. But then the diagram commutes up to sign for any  $i = 1, 2$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X, X \cup C_1 Y) & \xrightarrow{l^*} & \tilde{K}((X \cup C_1 Y) \cup C_2 X) & \xrightarrow{s^*} & \tilde{K}(X \cup C_1 Y) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow (r_i^*)^{-1} & & \downarrow \\ \tilde{K}^{-1}(X) & \xrightarrow{i^*} & \tilde{K}^{-1}(Y) & \xrightarrow{\delta} & K(X, Y) \end{array}$$

And the exactnes in the top row now proves exactnes in the bottom.  $\square$

Bevor we start constructing a Cohomology theory, we extend the K groups to be defined not oly over the negativs, but over the whole  $\mathbb{Z}$  which is done via an extension. The extension relies on periodic behaviour. Socalled Bott periodicity.

**Definition 4.5.12** (External Product). The **external product**  $\mu : K(X) \otimes K(Y) \rightarrow K(X \times Y)$  is defined via the two projections  $\pi_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$  and  $\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$  by:

$$\begin{aligned} \mu : K(X) \otimes K(Y) &\rightarrow K(X \times Y) \\ (a \otimes b) &\mapsto (\pi_X)^*(a) \cdot (\pi_Y)^*(b), \end{aligned}$$

where  $\cdot$  denotes the multiplication in the K-group, which was induced by the tensor Product. This  $\mu$  is a ring homomorphism, since:

$$\begin{aligned} \mu((a \otimes b)(c \otimes d)) &= \mu(ac \otimes bd) \\ &= \pi_X^*(ac) \pi_Y^*(bd) \\ &= \pi_X^*(a) \pi_X^*(c) \pi_Y^*(b) \pi_Y^*(d) \\ &= \pi_X^*(a) \pi_Y^*(b) \pi_X^*(c) \pi_Y^*(d) \\ &= \mu(a \otimes b) \mu(c \otimes d) \end{aligned}$$

By example 4.4.17 we know that for any line bundle  $l$ ,  $[l \otimes l \oplus \underline{1}] = [l]^2 + [\underline{1}] = [l] + [l]$  which is equivalent to  $([l] - 1)^2 = [l]^2 - [l] + [l] + [\underline{1}] = 0$ . Now  $\{[\underline{1}], [l]\}$  is an adddative basis of  $\mathbb{Z}/([l]^2 - [\underline{1}])$ . The mapping that is defined on a basis of the tensor product as follows

$$\begin{aligned} K(X) \otimes \left( \mathbb{Z}([l]) / ([l]^2 - [\underline{1}]) \right) &\rightarrow K(X \times S^2) \\ [\xi] \otimes [\underline{1}] &\mapsto \mu([\xi], [\underline{1}]) \\ [\xi] \otimes [l] &\mapsto \mu([\xi], [l]) \end{aligned}$$

is well defined.

thm:kTheo-fundamentalProductTheorem

**Theorem 4.5.13** (The Fundamental Product Theorem). *For any compact  $X$ , and the tautological line bundle  $l$  on  $\mathbb{CP}^1 \cong S^2$ , the mapping*

$$K(X) \otimes \left( \mathbb{Z}([l]) / ([l]^2 - [1]) \right) \rightarrow K(X \times S^2)$$

*is an isomorphism of rings.*

*Proof.* The proof is omitted here. There are elementary prooves given in Chapter 2.1 [hatcher2002algebraic] or Chapter 2.3 [Ati89].  $\square$

**Corollary 4.5.14.** If we take  $X$  to be a point, then Theorem 4.5.13 implies that

$$\Phi : \left( \mathbb{Z}([l]) / ([l]^2 - [1]) \right) \rightarrow K(S^2)$$

is an isomorphism. Hence,  $K(S^2)$  is generated by  $\{[1], [l]\}$ . Furtermore together with the map

$$\text{rank} : \left( \mathbb{Z}([l]) / ([l]^2 - [1]) \right) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

that maps the generator to their rank, and

$$\nu : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow K(pt); \quad n \mapsto [n]$$

we get the commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{Z}([l]) / ([l]^2 - [1]) & \xrightarrow{\text{rank}} & \mathbb{Z} \\ \downarrow \Phi & & \downarrow \nu \\ K(S^2) & \xrightarrow{i_{pt}^*} & K(pt) \end{array}$$

By the commutativity, we get a isomoprhism induced by  $\Phi$ :

$$\tilde{K}(S^2) = \ker(i_{pt}^*) \cong \ker(\text{rank}) = \text{span}([H] - [1])$$

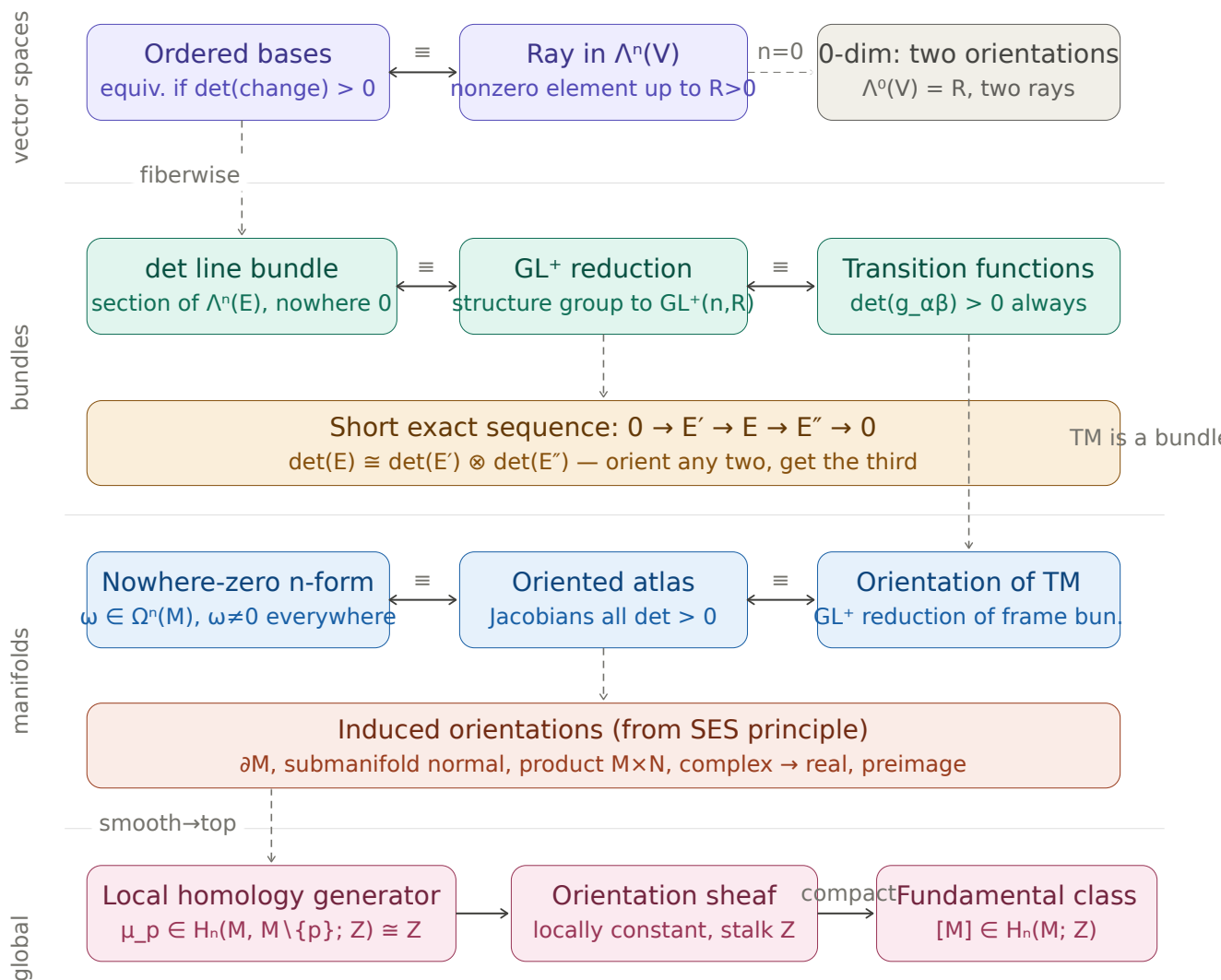


## 5 Orientations

### 5.1 Mathematical Goals

**Theorem 5.1.1** (The Theorems and Mathematical Structures). • *Define Orientations of Manifolds*

• *How to induce Orientations*



$[M] \cap - : H^k(M) \rightarrow H_{n-k}(M)$  (Poincaré dual)

The approach to this chapter is ...

## 6 Morse Theory

For everything concerning Morse theory our main reference will be the wonderful book [BH04]. In Morse theory, we will always deal with a smooth function  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  from a smooth Riemannian manifold  $(M, g)$  that is also compact. We will denote its dimension by  $m = \dim(M)$ .

**Definition 6.0.1** (Critical Points). A point  $p \in M$  at which the smooth map  $df_p = 0$  is called **critical**. By  $\text{Crit}(f)$  we denote the **set of critical points**.

**Definition 6.0.2** (The Hessian). Let  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a smooth function. The **Hessian** of  $f$  at  $p \in \text{Crit}(f)$  is a symmetric bilinear form

$$\text{Hess}_p(f) : T_p M \times T_p M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

that is defined as follows. Let  $\xi_p, \zeta_p \in T_p M$  be two tangent vectors. Now choose two vector fields  $\Xi$  and  $Z$  in a neighbourhood of  $p$  such that  $\Xi(p) = \xi_p$  and  $Z(p) = \zeta_p$ . We then define the Hessian to be:

$$\text{Hess}_p(f)(\xi_p, \zeta_p) = \Xi(Z(f))(p)$$

See 3.1.32 for the notation of applying a function to a vector field. In corollary 6.0.5 we will give a local description telling us that this definition is well defined, meaning independent of the Extensions  $\Xi$  and  $Z$ .

**Definition 6.0.3.** A smooth function  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is called **Morse**, if for any critical point, the Hessian is a symmetric bilinear and non-degenerate form.

For such a form there exists the following theorem:

**Theorem 6.0.4** (Sylvester's Law of Inertia). *Let  $A \in \text{Mat}(n, \mathbb{R})$  be symmetric and let  $T, T' \in \text{GL}(n, \mathbb{R})$  and  $k, k', l, l' \in \mathbb{N}$  such that:*

$$T^\top \circ A \circ T = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{1}_k & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\mathbb{1}_l & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0_{n-k-l} \end{pmatrix} \text{ and } T'^\top \circ A \circ T' = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{1}_{k'} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\mathbb{1}_{l'} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0_{n-k'-l'} \end{pmatrix}$$

*then  $k = k'$ ,  $l = l'$  and  $\text{rank}(A) = k + l$ .*

*Proof.* Since  $T, T'$  are invertible we have that

$$k + l = \text{rank}(T^\top \circ A \circ T) = \text{rank}(A) = \text{rank}(T'^\top \circ A \circ T') = k' + l'. \quad (11)$$

Hence it suffices to show that  $k = k'$ . Which we will do by proving the claim:

$$k = \max \{ \dim(U) \mid U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n \text{ subspace such that } x^\top A x > 0 \ \forall x \in U \setminus \{0\} \}$$

So we start by showing “ $\leq$ ” : Denote the first  $k$  columns of  $T$  with  $x_1, \dots, x_k$ . They form a basis of the subspace  $\mathbb{R}^k \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$  and with  $0 \neq x = \sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i x_i$  we have that by bilinearity

$$x^\top A x = \sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i x_i^\top A x = \sum_{i,j=1}^k \lambda_i \lambda_j x_i^\top A x_j = \sum_{i=1}^k (\lambda_i)^2 \geq 0. \quad (12)$$

This concludes the first inequality.

Now let  $U$  be any  $k$ -dimensional subspace such that for all non zero  $x \in U$ ,  $x^\top A x > 0$ . By a calculation analogous to the one above we have that for any  $x \in W := \text{span}(x_{k+1}, \dots, x_n)$  the number  $x^\top A x$  is less than or equal to zero. Hence,  $W \cap U = \{0\}$  and with this we conclude:

$$\dim(U) = \dim(U + W) - \dim(W) + \dim(U \cap W) \leq (k + (n - k)) - (n - k) + 0 = k. \quad (13)$$

This completes the proof.  $\square$

cor:morse-loc  
alHessian

**Corollary 6.0.5.** Let  $\varphi : U \rightarrow V$  be a chart around a critical point  $p \in M$ . Then in said chart the matrix corresponding to the Hessian has the form:

$$M_p(f) = \left( \frac{\partial^2(f \circ \varphi^{-1})}{\partial x_i \partial x_j} \right)_{i,j}$$

*Proof.* This follows by direct calculation of  $\text{Hess}_p(f)(\partial_i(p), \partial_j(p))$ . Denote  $x := \varphi(p)$ , then:

$$\begin{aligned} (\partial_i(p)(\partial_j(f)))_p &= \left( \partial_i(p) \left( p \mapsto \frac{\partial f \circ \varphi^{-1}}{\partial x_j} \Big|_{\varphi(p)} \right) \right)_p \\ &= \frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} \left( y \mapsto \frac{\partial f \circ \varphi^{-1}}{\partial x_j} \Big|_y \right) \Big|_x \\ &= \frac{\partial^2(f \circ \varphi^{-1})}{\partial x_i \partial x_j}. \end{aligned}$$

$\square$

**Remark 6.0.6.** If we have two different charts, then the matrix  $M_p(f)$  of the Hessian transforms from one basis to the other via conjugation of the differential of the transition function  $\varphi_{12} := \varphi_1 \circ \varphi_2^{-1}$ :

$$M_p^1(f) = (d\varphi_{12})^\top \cdot M_p^2(f) \cdot d\varphi_{12}$$

Hence we can define the following:

**Definition 6.0.7.** By Sylvester’s Law of inertia, the number  $l$  that denotes the dimension of the maximal subspace on which a matrix is negative definite, is an invariant under conjugation. We call that number the index of said matrix. Now in the setting of Morse theory we assign to each critical point  $p$  the index of  $M_p(f)$  and call that the **(Morse-)index** of  $p$ , denoted by  $\lambda_p$ . If omitting the function would cause ambiguity, we write  $\lambda_p^f$ . We denote the set of all critical points of index  $k$  by  $\text{Crit}_k(f)$ .

thm:morse-mor  
seLemma

**Theorem 6.0.8** (Morse Lemma). *Let  $p$  be a critical point of index  $k$  of the Morse function  $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ . There exists a centered chart  $\varphi : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$  around  $p$  such that*

$$(f \circ \varphi^{-1})(x_1, \dots, x_m) = f(p) + \sum_{i=1}^k -x_i^2 + \sum_{i=k+1}^m x_i^2.$$

*Proof.* We refer to Lemma 3.11 in [\[banyaga2004lectures\]](#) or [\[BH04\]](#) for a proof. □

## 7 Title

### 7.1 Mathematical Goals

- Theorem 7.1.1** (The Theorems and Mathematical Structures).

  - 
  -

The approach to this chapter is ...

## 8 Title

### 8.1 Mathematical Goals

**Theorem 8.1.1** (The Theorems and Mathematical Structures).

- 

- 

The approach to this chapter is ...

## References

- [Ati89] M. F. Atiyah. *K-theory*. Second. Advanced Book Classics. Notes by D. W. Anderson. Redwood City, CA: Addison-Wesley Publishing Company Advanced Book Program, 1989, pp. xx+216. ISBN: 0-201-09394-4.
- [BH04] A. Banyaga and D. Hurtubise. *Lectures on Morse Homology*. Texts in the Mathematical Sciences. Springer Netherlands, 2004. ISBN: 9781402026959. URL: [https://books.google.de/books?id=AX-\\_sbMj0K4C](https://books.google.de/books?id=AX-_sbMj0K4C).
- [Bro96] Jacek Brodzki. *An Introduction to K-theory and Cyclic Cohomology*. 1996. arXiv: [funct-an/9606001](https://arxiv.org/abs/funct-an/9606001). URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/funct-an/9606001>.
- [Cou04] Dennis Courtney. *A Brief Glance at K-theory*. 2004. URL: <https://math.berkeley.edu/~hutching/teach/215b-2004/courtney.pdf>.
- [CP61] A. H. Clifford and G. B. Preston. *The Algebraic Theory of Semigroups*. Vol. I. Mathematical Surveys 7. Providence, R.I.: American Mathematical Society, 1961.
- [Gre65] J. A. Green. *Sets and Groups*. London: Routledge & Kegan Paul, 1965.
- [Hat02] Allen Hatcher. *Algebraic Topology*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2002. ISBN: 978-0-521-79540-1.
- [Lan05] Gregory D. Landweber. *K-Theory and Elliptic Operators*. 2005. arXiv: [math/0504555](https://arxiv.org/abs/math/0504555). URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/math/0504555>.
- [Ste67] N. E. Steenrod. “A convenient category of topological spaces”. In: *Michigan Mathematical Journal* 14.2 (1967), pp. 133–152. DOI: [10.1307/mmj/1028999711](https://doi.org/10.1307/mmj/1028999711).
- [Str] Neil P. Strickland. *The Category of CGWH Spaces*. Unpublished note, <https://ncatlab.org/nlab/files/StricklandCGWHSpaces.pdf>. abgerufen am 25. Juni 2026.
- [tom08] Tammo tom Dieck. *Algebraic Topology*. EMS Textbooks in Mathematics. European Mathematical Society (EMS), Zürich, 2008. ISBN: 978-3-03719-048-7. DOI: [10.4171/048](https://doi.org/10.4171/048).